天下有风
Flowing in the Wind

目录 / Contents

更漏长 / Dripping Inside the Hourglass 2
流水今日 / A Flood of Memories 7
有所求 / Want Something 12
不同谋 / Part Ways 18
身非木石 / Heart of Flesh 23
壶中天 / The Limited Sky in the Teapot 28
歧路无多 / No More Astray 34
平芜尽处 / After the Endless Plain 37

更漏长
Dripping Inside the Hourglass CH16603-01

???: ...
???: ……

???: ... I just ...
???: ……方才……

Gradually regaining sight, the bird spies the furnishings of a simple office and the face of an old man staring back at him.
视野逐渐清晰，屋内的陈设与说话人的面庞随之切实地映入眼中。

The old man, with a face both worried and confused, seems to be reiterating a previous statement.
这是一张带有关切神色的脸，在皱纹中似乎还藏有少许疑虑。它属于正对葛天发问的男性老者。

Lizheng: So you've said your name was Gětiān Yànpíng, and you've come to this city in search of two lost belongings.
里正：依您方才所言，您名为燕平，此番入城是为寻两样随身物件。

Lizheng: Is that correct?
里正：是也不是?

The eagerness in the man's tone finally drags Gětiān's wandering soul back into his body.
略带急迫的语气正如一条缰绳，有助于拽回漫散的思绪。

Yanping: Yes. You may call me, Yànpíng.
燕平：正是。

Yanping: Forgive me, my mind is scattered—must be in need of rest after my trip.
燕平：也许是奔波劳累的缘故，我有些走神。但并不妨事。

Yanping: Whatever else do you need to know?
燕平：您还有何疑问?

Lizheng: Well, we've made a mock-up of your belongings. Please check if they match your description.
里正：噢，这是根据您的描述所绘制的图样，需得您确认一番。

Lizheng: We've never seen anything like these particular items in our city, so I'm afraid I'll have to ask you to tell us a little more about them.
里正：另外，此两样物件，城中以往并不曾有过。恐怕还需您多费些工夫，略为叙说其来历。

The old man puts the files aside and unfolds two pieces of yellowed paper.
老者将桌面的文书推往一侧，在葛天面前摊开两卷淡黄纸张。

Lizheng: Take your time. Let me know if there's anything incorrect.
里正：便在此了。您可细细查阅，如有缺漏之处，还请直言。

Yànpíng pins the pictures down with his wing and checks them over carefully.
燕平沉默着抬起一侧羽翼，压住纸张的边角，投以视线。

Yanping: Yes, it's a good rendition. You should know the wand is made of bone, and the pendant of jade.
燕平：……并无任何缺漏，与我随身的骨杖及玉佩一般无二。

Lizheng: So, are these valuable, in any way?
里正：这样说来，想必都是贵重饰物?

Yanping: No. Not as you mean it. The wand itself is no more than a common tool. Used to cast arcane skills, but no different from the calligraphy brushes, flagons, or brooms other people use.
燕平：并非如此。骨杖是我平日施术所用，与那些用毛笔、酒壶、笤帚施术之人一般，只是从身边取用的寻常物件。

Lizheng: Oh, so you use it to cast your arcane skills.
里正：原来是您的术杖。

The old man nods thoughtfully, before following with another question.
老者若有所思地点了点头，随即开口追问。

Lizheng: You just said it was a "common tool" ... So where you're from, arcanists don't need any sort of special wand?
里正：只是，依您所言“寻常”一词……在您的来处有许多神秘学家，他们所用的术杖也极为普通?

Lizheng: Flagons, brooms, swords, sticks, even, eh, you said calligraphy brushes? It seems like anything could be used to cast arcane skills?
里正：且不论“毛笔”，酒壶、扫帚，乃至刀剑棍棒，竟都可用于施展神秘术?

Yanping: I'm sure you've seen it for yourself. Arcanists are everywhere, even here I presume. Then you must know it is the caster's will that triggers the skill, the tool is only a medium, a matter of style rather than necessity.
燕平：自然。神秘学家随处可见，有何稀奇？施术不过随心念所动，又何须刻意挑选媒介?

Gětiān blinks at the man, confused at his strange ignorance of such basic precepts of arcanum.
话语中显露的差异使燕平有些疑虑，抬头望向老者。

The old man seems to read nothing into Gětiān's stare and continues.
而老者也并未回避他质询的目光。

Lizheng: Ah, well, we're sort of remote, so many things are different here ... I try not to assume.
里正：喔，大概是此地偏远，许多事难免不能与外界相同。

Lizheng: I didn't mean to offend. I only was curious, we have arcanists here of course, but we know little about those outside of our community.
里正：还望您不要见怪。城中也有许多神秘学家，我只是未曾想过，还有他处与此城相仿。

Yanping: The world is vast indeed ...
燕平：天下之大，事物亦繁多。不足为奇。

Lizheng: That's true.
里正：的确，的确。

Lizheng: So then this bone wand is your top priority. We are short of manpower right now, but I'll have it found.
里正：既然如此，看来这根术杖更为重要。
城中人力有限，我会安排他们加紧寻找此物……

Yanping: ... No.
燕平：……不。

Lizheng: Hmm?
里正：嗯……?

The old man wrinkles his face in surprise at the bird's response, yet it comes to rest back to a smile again.
这句否认使老者惊讶地抬起眉毛。但他很快就平静下来，再次挂上微笑。

Lizheng: As you said the pendent is of no great value. To be honest, it seems quite ordinary, I think it's unlikely it will be stolen.
里正：至于玉佩，您也不必担心。我便说得直些，这般普通物件，并无什么人有意拿取。

Lizheng: But the wand is a different case. The consequences of such a tool ending up in the wrong hands is certainly more severe.
里正：但您的术杖则不同。若不快些动作，恐怕会遇着有心人藏匿、偷占。这样便麻烦了。

Lizheng: Nonetheless, we will try to have them both returned to you.
里正：两枚物件，我们必定将其寻回，原样奉还。

Yanping: Thank you. I only meant that I can't say that the wand is a greater priority to me.
燕平：多谢。我只是一时难以肯定，骨杖是否“更为重要”。

Lizheng: Why is that? The wand is an arcane tool, I can only guess it must be more valuable ...
里正：这有何难？那骨杖到底也是神秘学物品，其价值……

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

The old man must have sensed Yànpíng's hesitation, so he cuts himself off to ask another more pointed question.
老者察觉到燕平的犹豫，打住了话头，另起一问。

Lizheng: Heh heh, of course, I should have asked first. Which one is more valuable to you?
里正：哈哈，也是我想得窄了。那在您看来，哪件东西价值更高，更值得珍重?

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

Gětiān replies with silence. Only the rustle of the feathers and the drip-drops of a water clock can be heard.
厅室之内仍然一片静默，仅有羽翼轻微抖动的窸窣声响，以及更漏中流水的清脆回音。

The worn stone floor is smooth and cold, proving uncomfortable to stand on compared to a branch.
地面的石板被磨损得发白，光滑而冰冷，并不如树木枝干那般易于安稳停落。

Gětiān folds his wings, with claws tapping on the stone floor gently.
燕平收拢翅膀，趾爪在石板上轻轻敲击着。

Yanping: I cannot say ...
燕平：我不知。

Yanping: I should need to think it through, before I give an answer.
燕平：此问还需多加思量。

Surprised by Yànpíng's response, the old man leans in with interest.
燕平的回答似乎并不在老者意料之中，但却使他颇感趣味。

Lizheng: I see. Please, take your time.
里正：这般，您尽可仔细思索再作回答。

Lizheng: We may need to wait some time for your belongings to be found, you're welcome to stay here and talk with me.
里正：寻物总归要费工夫，空坐也是无趣。您不若与我闲谈，在此稍待片刻。

Lizheng: I happen to need help with some questions of my own. Of course, you can ask me any that you have as well, whatever comes to mind.
里正：正好尚有些疑惑需向您请教。当然，您若有任何问题，也只管提出就是。

Yanping: By all means, go ahead.
燕平：但说无妨。

Lizheng: There is a young girl who runs a tavern in the city that has gone missing. We searched every corner but, still haven't found her.
里正：这几日，城中有一位酒坊娘子不见踪影，大家着急忙慌地寻过，无甚收获。

Lizheng: She was wearing a red dress with a blue-green top. Did you happen to see her before you entered the city?
里正：——您入城前，是否曾在周遭见过着红裙、青衫，约莫桃李年华的姑娘?

Yanping: No.
燕平：不曾。

Lizheng: She has a friend, a foreign merchant of the same age with red hair, very eye-catching. Would that help at all?
里正：那姑娘有位胡商友人，发色赤红，格外显眼，也是与她一般年纪。您又是否见过?

Yanping: No, it would not.
燕平：亦是不曾。

Lizheng: Please, search your memories ... they might have been near a bridge.
里正：您——请您再想一想，分明在一座桥边——

Yanping: A bridge?
燕平：……桥?

The word conjures up a memory. Indeed, there was a bridge.
这个字眼似乎能与记忆中的画面对应。他确实知道这样一座桥。

Yanping: Built over the cliff, broken in two. Many have tried to make it over, and nearly as many failed. At least the skeletons below tell me so.
燕平：那桥早已毁去，不可通行。桥下许多白骨，皆是想要跃过断口的人与动物所留。

Lizheng: And what about the other side of the bridge?
里正：桥的对面又是何处?

Yanping: I recall further on there are trees, yes ... then rivers, then mountains, and a heavy fog that separates this place from there.
燕平：山，树，河流，将这些景物与我们分隔的浓雾。别无其他。

Yanping: The ones you're looking for would have no reason to jump that gap, if they could even manage it ...
燕平：你要寻的二人，没有理由，也绝无可能跃过桥去。

He places a certainty in his tone, as if to stop the old man's questions, or at least convince him he in fact hasn't seen them.
他本以为，笃定的话语能令老者停止追问，也能说服自己。

Yet now he feels a rising uncertainty inside himself.
但疑虑仍旧像一阵令人不适的细小气流，在羽毛之下穿行。

Lizheng: We will have to expand the search then. *sighs* I hope they're alright.
里正：那便只有多朝几处去寻了。唉，还望她们平安。

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

He thinks back to the bridge, as well as the parting that happened there.
他记得那座桥，也记得在此处发生的交谈与离别。

There was a building on the other side of the gap, and yes, someone did jump across it.
桥的对面本应有建筑，也应当曾有在他眼前纵身跃过断桥的人。

Someone in a striking red dress, hard to miss against its plain surroundings.
——那身影在黯淡的木头与石块之上格外显眼，恰好是红色。

???: What about Jiǔ Niángzǐ? She jumped over the bridge. Is she never coming back?
???: ……曲娘呢？她也过去了。但她是不是，不会再回来了？

???: Perhaps we will meet again one day.
???: 也许在别的地方，会再见到的。

Yanping: Jiǔ Niángzǐ ...?
燕平：曲娘……？

The memory and the name pop up in his mind, but for now he has to put them aside.
他暂且将这个名字，还有这番突兀涌现的景象放置在脑海一角。

The old man remained locked in his stare all this time, before breaking the tension with another question.
老者始终关注着他的举动，此刻适时地开口插话。

Lizheng: Did you remember something?
里正：您可是想起了什么？

Yanping: Naught that is of any use.
燕平：琐事而已。

Yanping: My apologies. There is nothing I can do.
燕平：很遗憾，寻人一事，我恐怕无能为力。

Lizheng: Oh ... Never mind then. We should talk more about your ...
里正：这……也无妨，我们还是说回——

Yanping: My wand, perhaps?
燕平：——说回我的骨杖。

Yanping: I presume you wish to know how to use it and whether it may do harm to you.
燕平：或许你还想知道如何使用它，它是否会对你有所妨害。

Yanping: We have spent too much time circling about each other.
燕平：这些互相试探的问话，已经耗去太多时间。

Lizheng: Circling? No, no! I ...
里正：试探？不，不！这——

Yanping: Take no mind of it, I will tell you what I know.
燕平：无妨。我会将这些详尽地告知你。

Lizheng: ...!
里正：——!

The old man puts on a shocked face, its contours look strange for his age. Like a momentary glimpse of a younger man.
老者的脸上浮现出与他模样并不相符的震惊，看上去甚至有几分滑稽。

Yanping: As I said, this wand is not of any great power, but it has its uses to me and I would have it back.
燕平：正如此前所说，这枚骨杖于我而言并不是多么珍贵的物件，但也有其用处，不可失去。

Yanping: I will satisfy your curiosity. But then you must return it, at once.
燕平：因此，我选择满足你的好奇。希望你听完能将它归还给我。

Lizheng: Certainly. We are not thieves, after all.
里正：……自然。我们并非盗匪，不会强占他人财物。

Yanping: As I am just a visitor here, and you, my host. All I can do is make a humble request.
燕平： 毕竟，您是此地的主人，而我是来客。我只能这般请求。

Somehow the request comes across as more of a polite warning.
与其说是请求，这更像礼貌的警示。

Yet the old man seems not to sense the implication at all. He heaves a sigh of relief and nods along with Gětiān.
但老者仿佛对其中暗含的意味毫无察觉，反而是松了口气般，连连点头应下燕平的话。

Lizheng: No problem, no problem at all.
里正： 理应如此，理应如此。

Yanping: Good, things are simpler when the truth is out in the open. I will tell you about my wand, but first you need to answer my question.
燕平： 把话说开，一切便简单了。答过骨杖一问后，我也有一问要还与你。

Yanping: I can plainly see your bones don't fit your appearance.
燕平： 在我看来，你的骨相与这副形貌并不相符。

Yanping: Are you disguised as someone else?
燕平： ——你可有假借他人身份?

Lizheng: Hmm. You already have your answer, don't you?
里正： 唔。你既然问出口，想必已有答案。

Lizheng: But I will answer your question only after you answer mine.
里正： 待你说完，我定会给出交待。

He slightly nods and signals to Yànpíng.
他微微颔首，朝燕平做了个手势。

Lizheng: Please.
里正： 请吧。

6#1
6#1

流水今日
A Flood of Memories CH16603-02

Getian's Clan Mate: Life in the mountain is indeed carefree.
葛天族人： 山中之日，果然悠闲自在。

Getian's Clan Mate: Listen, there's the wind, the rustling leaves, and the chirping birds, all much more beautiful than that awful racket that humans make.
葛天族人： 像这般立在枝头，听听风声、叶声、鸟鸣声，岂不比市井喧闹要好得多?

Getian's Clan Mate: Do you think so, Yànpíng?
葛天族人： ——你说是么，燕平?

The bird called Yànpíng moves carefully to the trunk of the tree, so he could hide in the shadow.
被喊到名字的鸟儿谨慎地往树枝一侧挪了挪，以便将自己纳入叶片的荫蔽下。

Yanping: I've never left the mountain. Which is more annoying, the noises made by humans, or those made by animals?
燕平： 我不曾往山下去过。市井喧闹之声，比之兽类打闹的喧哗，如何?

Getian's Clan Mate: To you, I think they would both be annoying, just in different ways.
葛天族人： 按你的性子来看，那便是各有其扰人处。

Getian's Clan Mate: I admit, listening to the daily conversation of humans and their haggling in the market can sometimes be interesting.
葛天族人：若要我说，人们在坊市中的叫卖与交谈，倒是别有趣味。

Yanping: Is that so?
燕平：这样。

Birds like any intelligent creature can have different personalities and hobbies.
即使是同族，彼此间的性格与喜好也不尽相同。

One can tell the differences between them by listening carefully to their chirps. One might be loud and talkative, while the other makes only a few short sounds in reply.
在槐树之下驻足细听，便可分辨出鸟鸣的差异。密集而明亮的声音之下，偶尔会掺杂几个单薄的音节。

Getian's Clan Mate: They do invent many new and useful things, some that maybe you will need one day.
葛天族人：山下人常有些新奇的创造，学来说不准就能派上用场。

Getian's Clan Mate: Like bricks. Our nests have been much better protected since they showed me how to make them.
葛天族人：自从得了他们制砖瓦的法子，我们的巢穴就没再让雨水泡散架了。

Yanping: That's true.
燕平：确实如此。

Getian's Clan Mate: And the technique of making beautiful melodies with bamboo and wood with holes, or the doodles they draw that can hold their words ...
葛天族人：还有让那些竹条、木板发出优美音律的技巧，把说过的话记录下来的涂鸦……

Getian's Clan Mate: They can even measure time, using something they call a "calendar."
葛天族人：甚至有用于度量四季更替、时间流逝的一套规则，他们称之为“历法”。

Getian's Clan Mate: They can see into the essence of ordinary things and dream up wondrous creations from them.
葛天族人：本是寻常事物，在他们看来竟又有了其他意味。

Getian's Clan Mate: If you look at the world like a human does, you will probably be shocked by its vastness.
葛天族人：用山下人的眼光观察四周，恐怕会觉得天地实在辽阔。

Yanping: It is.
燕平：嗯。

Getian's Clan Mate: ... Yànpíng.
葛天族人：……燕平。

Getian's Clan Mate: I know you don't care about humans, but I feel I should tell you everything I want to say.
葛天族人：我知道你一向对这些不感兴趣，但我也总觉着，需找个机会将要说的话全说干净。

Yànpíng moves back to where he had stood before, right next to the other bird. Their wings rubbing against each other, with feathers puffing out.
听到这句话，燕平自树荫下迈步，挪回原来的位置。两只鸟儿站得近，翅膀挤挨着，蓬出几根不安分的羽毛。

Yanping: So ... you are leaving too.
燕平：你也要下山了。

Yanping: Well, it's only a matter of time. Good luck.
燕平：这不过也是早晚之事，祝你顺利。

Getian's Clan Mate: Thank you.
葛天族人：借你吉言。

In a rare moment of silence in the tree. One of the birds stretches his wing to cover the other.
枝头难得迎来了片刻安静。其中一只鸟儿伸出翅膀，代替树叶投下阴凉。

Getian's Clan Mate: You're still unwilling to leave the mountain ... Is it because you can't bear to stay away from home?
葛天族人：你不愿下山，是因为不舍这片土地?

Yanping: I simply have not found a reason to leave.
燕平：我只是……寻不到应当如此的缘由。

Getian's Clan Mate: Your time has not yet come, I guess, but that's fine, we need someone to take care of our nests and belongings ... I'll leave my books and instruments to you.
葛天族人：唔，也许是时机未到。这样也好，得麻烦你照料大家的巢，还有那堆收集的小物件……我的书本和乐器便托给你了。

Getian's Clan Mate: You are the first one born in the Central Plains after we migrated. I think you will adapt to the environment here faster than we do.
葛天族人：你是第一个在中原出生的，或许会比迁徙而来的我们更适应这儿的风土吧。

Getian's Clan Mate: We are so used to living high in the sky. When we look down, both the cities and the people are no different from dirt piles. Only by living among them can we truly experience the prosperity described in the poems.
葛天族人：我们所习惯的地方太高了。从高空往下望，城、人，都只是灰扑扑的土堆——但若生活其中，大概能真正体会到诗文中所写的繁盛景象。

Getian's Clan Mate: I think you will leave the mountain one day.
葛天族人：我想，总有一天，你会动身下山。

Yanping: But not for now, at least.
燕平：至少不是近日。

Yanping: It's not yet time for me to think of such things.
燕平：现在谈论这些，实在是为时过早。

Getian's Clan Mate: Just as well ... You glide slowly just like always.
葛天族人：好吧，好吧……你这慢悠悠的性子。

Getian's Clan Mate: Hopefully I'll be useful to our people one day. I don't want to become another lazy bone always snoozing beneath the tree ...
葛天族人：希望我最后是块有用的骨头，别像旁边树上那家伙似的，尽记了些絮絮叨叨的废话……

The seasons changed, beasts and birds came and went away. And the traces they had left behind were gone in less than a day as the leaves fell.
逢着时节更替，山中鸟兽来去频繁，今日树底的足迹，及至明日，往往隐入叶丛，不复再见。

The stream flows downwards and the wind blows its course night and day as always.
溪水与山风倒是不分昼夜，日日奔涌。

Yanping: You've returned.
燕平：你回来了。

Bone Collector: Hmm, who ... Ah, it's you, Yànpíng.
拾骨人：哦，是……我瞧瞧，是燕平啊。

Yanping: Whose bones are these?
燕平：这次是谁的骨头?

Bone Collector: Not your friends', I'm afraid.
拾骨人：很遗憾，没有你的老熟人。

Bone Collector: I will take them all to our temple. You may check them yourself should you wish.
拾骨人：我会把这些家伙都送入族中祠堂，你若好奇，到时自行前去查看即可。

Yanping: I will.
燕平：我知道。

Bone Collector: Quite some time has passed. Yet, still you choose not to leave the mountain.
拾骨人：这么些日子过去了，你还是没有下山的打算。

Bone Collector: Well, given the situation of our race, I guess you will be the last one left to take care of our bones.
拾骨人：我估摸着，按如今族中的境况，为族人收敛骨骸的职责最后也只能落到你身上。

Bone Collector: You will have to leave one day.
拾骨人：你终究还是得去一趟的。

Yanping: I thank you for the reminder. Now, please leave me alone.
燕平：多谢关照，你且去忙吧。

The bird robed in loose clothing stretches its wings and flies towards the point of a roof far away.
树下身披宽松织物的鸟儿耸了耸羽翼，朝着远处的檐角飞去。

Yanping: ... It is fine weather for a nap.
燕平：……也算是个休憩的好天气。

Yanping: Both the mountain and the human world are between the sky and the earth. Are they really different?
燕平：山上山下，都在天地方圆之间，有何区别?

Yanping: Anyway, the breeze feels comfortable now. I should take a nap.
燕平：不如趁这阵风，打个盹先。

Yanping: There are so many bones left in the temple. It could take a hundred years or even more to read through each one's stories.
燕平：族人们存留在祠堂中的骨头那样多，他们所记之事，就算花费几十上百年，也难以彻底了解。

Yanping: I might have a long life, but I'd still rather spend that time on the things I'm actually interested in.
燕平：何况，有这样漫长的寿命，尽可以琢磨任何感兴趣的事物。

Yanping: These stories have nothing to do with me.
燕平：他人的因果，又与我何干呢。

Yanping: There is no need for me to leave the mountain.
燕平：我本可以不必下山。

The beasts in the mountain remained there for several generations, until the rocks in the stream had been polished smooth.
山间的兽群已繁衍数代，溪涧旁的岩石也已被水流冲蚀，打磨平整。

But the scholar tree where the birds rested remained as green as ever.
唯独鸟儿们停驻的槐树兀自舒展着枝叶，始终长青，无论四季。

Yanping: Our kind has not had a new generation for a long time.
燕平：许久以来，不曾见有新的同族诞生。

Yanping: I don't think anyone will be able to collect my bones and move them to the temple if I die outside this mountain.
燕平：如果我也留在山下，想必无人能够代为捡拾我的骸骨。

Yanping: In that case, then the tombs here would eventually be buried by weeds.
燕平：……此地也会被草木覆盖吧。

Yanping: We migrated and followed the humans. We studied from different cultures. We put so much effort into prolonging the lives of our people.
燕平：迁徙，追逐人类，学习我们此前不曾了解的文化，终究都无法令族群存续。

Yanping: Yet it was all in vain, as I expected.
燕平：正如我所预料，这一切不过徒劳。

What eventually led him to leave the mountain was a summoning. In layman's terms, it was like a wordless awareness or calling.
催促他动身的仅是一个念头，以这片土地上常用的说法，可以被称作灵犀，或是感召。

Every member of his race would have felt it. Whenever it happened, they each would fold their wings and lower their heads, and the bone collector would set off to where the bones lay.
所有族人都熟悉这种体验，每至此刻，他们会收拢羽翼，垂头静默。拾骨人则振翅离去，前往同族最后停留的方向。

Yanping: Better make it quick.
燕平：还是早去早回为好。

Yanping: It's not far. Good, it's not too close to the human city. I won't be interrupted.
燕平：就在附近。离城中尚有一段路，不易被人打扰。这倒方便许多。

Yanping: He must have been on his way back to the mountain ... but didn't make it.
燕平：看样子，他或是曾打算赶回族内……只是略迟了些。

Yanping: No matter. I'll take him back.
燕平：也无妨，我可为他代劳。

From his view high in the sky, spotting the white bones strewn across the green foliage was a simple matter.
对惯于俯瞰地面的鸟儿而言，从错杂的枝叶之间寻到一星白色也并不算太难。

Seeing his target, he folded his wings and landed.
此行已有收获，可以放缓扇动羽翼的速度，落至土壤之上。

Yanping: We meet again.
燕平：又见面了。

He examined the skull beneath the cloth, and felt for a second it peered back at him. The wilderness was silent, as if the place were long abandoned.
骨头不发一言，披着薄布静静地与他对视。它们像是被随意弃置此处的杂物。

Like how they used to, he kept a bit of a distance, but this time the bones did not hop forward to meet him.
就像过去交谈时那样，鸟儿们仍旧隔着些许距离。只是这层分隔不再能轻易地跨越。

One wing covered the other again.
一道影子盖住另一道影子。

Yanping: You know, I often wondered why every bone collector would eventually leave the mountain, just as you did. Was it the scenery, the people ... something else?
燕平：我时常会想，是否每任拾骨人都在途中被这些景色吸引，于是不久后，做出同样的选择。

Yanping: You left to help humans build cities and bridges. You even sought out water sources and gave them your so-called advice.
燕平：你们到山下去，帮助他们建城，筑桥，寻觅水源或者给出所谓的谏言。

Yanping: What is your purpose?
燕平： 所欲为何?

There was no reply. He hadn't cast the arcane skill that might allow the skull to speak.
他并未使用能与骨头对话的神秘术。因此这疑问必然落空。

Yànpíng lowered his head and found a line of ants climbing through a hole in the skull.
燕平垂下头，从头骨上的空洞中能看到几只蚂蚁正努力攀爬。

Yanping: To verify that you have learned the right knowledge? To offer help to the creatures similar to you?
燕平： 为了让你们学得的知识得到验证？为了对与自己相似的族类施以援助?

Yanping: ...
燕平： ……

Yanping: Or you just simply could not resist the desire to do so?
燕平： 还是仅仅无法抵抗欲望?

Yànpíng stayed there with the silent bones for a long time. Before he took wing again.
影子长久地停留在此处。片刻后，燕平抬起翅膀。

Yanping: No matter.
燕平： 罢了。

Yanping: "All men, whether great or ordinary, will end up a pile of bones." There's nothing else I can say.
燕平： “生则尧、舜，死则腐骨。”现下也没什么可说。

Yanping: It's time to return.
燕平： 该回山上了。

6#1
6#1

有所求
Want Something CH16603-03

Yanping: For as long as we draw breath we're migrating, and then at the moment of our death, we are reduced to bones in an instant. Thus, we take our people's bones with us wherever we move. It is our way.
燕平： 我与我的同族，生则不断迁徙飞行，死后转瞬便化作白骨。当我们迁往新的栖息之地，也会带上族人的遗骸。

Yanping: This wand not merely a tool to me.
燕平： 因此骨杖于我而言，不仅是施术的工具。

Lizheng: So then the bone came from ...
里正： ……竟是如此。这骨杖莫非是……

Yanping: My clan mate's wing.
燕平： 是取羽翼上的骨节所制。

Yanping: I learned how to carve from humans, so that I might make this wand.
燕平： 为此，我特意研习过山下人的雕刻技术。

He reads the old man's reaction, hoping he might capture some clue from his response.
他边说边观察着老者的神色，试图从中寻到一些可用的信息。

The old man raises his eyebrows, mouth slightly open but wordless, eyes open and fixed straight on him. It is shock.
挑起的眉毛，微微张开的嘴巴，笔直的视线。根据经验判断，这很可能是受惊吓的表现。

Yanping: My apologies, if I've caused offense. There may be cultural differences between us ...
燕平：抱歉。我一时忘记，山下人的习俗与我们不……

Lizheng: So then you're a bone carver! What a surprise!
里正：真是没有想到，您竟也对骨雕感兴趣！

Yanping: ...?
燕平：——?

Lizheng: I know of a place that would be perfect for you!
里正：我知道一处地方，要是您之后有机会到了那儿，必定舍不得离开！

Lizheng: It is called Nizhny Novgorod. Cool name, isn't it? There are many craftsmen there, and they make lions, tigers, reindeer, and even dragons out of bones! Their handicrafts are used as accessories on sheaths.
里正：瞧瞧这个闪亮的名字：下诺夫格罗德。许多工匠在这里雕刻出狮子、老虎、驯鹿与飞龙，或者镶嵌在刀鞘上的漂亮饰品。

Lizheng: Can you imagine that? Legendary creatures coming to life through simple engravings on old bones ...
里正：天哪，您能想象吗？故事中描述的生物在刻刀之下生长而出，他们用死去的材料创造如此鲜活的工艺品——

Yanping: Calm yourself, sir.
燕平：……请保持镇定。

Yanping: Otherwise, I think I may have to cast a calming arcane skill.
燕平：否则，我认为有必要使用能使人平静的神秘术。

Lizheng: Oh, please! Don't worry. I'm totally fine. I'm not rabid! I'm only happy for you.
里正：噢，噢！不必担心，我完全正常，并不打算咬人或是干点什么别的攻击您。

Lizheng: Ah, but I almost forgot, I promised to tell you everything, so I don't think you would like to see this false image anymore.
里正：差点儿忘了，用这副模样同您说话，您大概会感到不太习惯。我也向您许诺过会给出交待，当然。

Lizheng: Please hold on a second.
里正：请您稍等片刻，几秒钟就成。

A second later, the old man's image fades away like a drop of ink in water.
只是眨眼的工夫，老者的轮廓就像水中化开的一滴墨那般消散。

The face revealed beneath is surprisingly young.
底下露出的面庞年轻得让人意外。

He tidies up his appearance, already decent enough, and begins again more seriously.
他理了理那身已经足够整齐的衣服，煞有介事地开口。

???: Alright. Please allow me to introduce myself one more time.
???：好了，该向您重新做个自我介绍。

Leonid: You may call me "Leonid," "Hey, you," or "Employee," the name doesn't matter. Just pick one to make communication easier.
列昂尼德：您可以叫我列昂尼德，或者“那家伙”、“职员”之类的，名字不太重要，只是为了聊天儿方便。

Leonid: I work for the St. Pavlov Foundation. I don't think you would know of it, but it's an organization which provides support for arcanists and collects their information. So far it has helped countless arcanists.
列昂尼德：我供职于圣诺夫基金会，看样子，我猜您是不了解的。这是个收集了大量神秘学家信息并为他们提供必要援助的庞大组织。

Leonid: I work at the Russian branch. Like the other branches, we are committed to helping arcanists. It's part of our duty.
列昂尼德：我们俄罗斯分部当然也将这份职责好好担了起来，致力于满足各位的合理诉求。

Leonid: For example, if you are attacked by critters when you take a nap on the park bench, call us—but try to make sure you hadn't just drank too much vodka first.
列昂尼德：打个比方，您躺在公园长椅上打盹儿，被不知道哪儿来的魔精袭击，就可以拨打电话投诉——不过请首先确定这不是伏特加造成的幻觉。

Leonid: In truth, I love this job. It gives me the opportunities to get in touch with new things and people ...
列昂尼德：从我个人的角度来说，这是份不错的职务，可以见到不少新鲜的人和事。

Leonid: Like you, a rare case even among arcanists.
列昂尼德：例如，像您这样少见的——神秘学家。

Leonid: I owe you an apology, to be honest. We were going to catch those big critters with corn and wheat. You know, they haunt this place in winter. Never expected to see you here.
列昂尼德：老实说，我得跟您道个歉。大伙儿本来是拿那些玉米粒和小麦捉大型魔精。这地方临到冬季常有魔精出没。谁知道竟误打误撞地碰着了您。

Leonid: We thought you were a new species, but you are ... half man? So they called me here, just in case.
列昂尼德：我们还以为您是未曾见过的新品种，但您又具有——具有人形。为防万一，他们便叫我来处理。

Gětiān has little sense of most of the technical jargon the now young man is speaking, but manages to capture the key information.
从一连串陌生的词汇中，鸟儿敏锐地捕捉到了少数他能理解的内容。

Yanping: Please, you don't have to do anything. It was I who ate the crops without permission. I should repay you for them.
燕平：事出有因，是我误食了有主的粮食，理应赔偿。

Yanping: So how much are they?
燕平：这些粮食，价值几何?

Leonid: Oh, only a few Sharpodonties. It's already forgotten. Now back to bone carving, seriously ...
列昂尼德：噢，也不过费一点利齿子儿。您不必挂念，还是让我继续和您探讨骨雕，说真的……

Yanping: Please ... wait. What is this "Sharpodonty"?
燕平：请……稍等。这“利齿子儿”，又是何物?

Leonid: A currency widely used by arcanists. I heard it has become popular even in the East now. Have you never seen one before?
列昂尼德：通行的货币，神秘学家们大多都用这个。我曾听说在东方，它也逐渐普及开了。难道您从未见过?

Yanping: If you mean the things people use to "trade," the one I usually see is a round coin made of copper, with a hole in the middle. Though where I am from, many people simply barter.
燕平：若此物用于“交易”这一行为，我所常见的是以物易物，或是使用铜制、圆形带孔的钱币。

They look into each other's eyes, each bewildered, not sure what to say next.
疑惑的眼睛对上另一双疑惑的眼睛，陷入迷茫的交谈者们面面相觑。

They're two very different creatures each from a very different culture.
认知差异划下的鸿沟似乎比想象中还要更深。

Leonid: Well, I'm not sure I see how to carry on our current conversation. Let's stop the Artificial Somnambulism and find another place to talk.
列昂尼德：等等，我想这不是三两句话能说清楚的，我们得停止人工梦游，换个更适合交谈的地方……

Leonid: Please close your eyes ... I'll take you to a room where we can sit.
列昂尼德：麻烦您……您先闭起眼睛。我领您找一处合适的房间坐下。

Yanping: Alright.
燕平：好。

Leonid: The corridors of our branch can be kind of narrow. You may find your wings brushing along the wall.
列昂尼德：您小心翅膀，分部的走廊算不上宽敞，磕碰都是常见的。

Yanping: I will be careful.
燕平：我会注意。

Leonid: I have another question.
列昂尼德：我想向您验证一个猜想。

Yanping: By all means, go ahead.
燕平：但说无妨。

Leonid: It seems there is no language barrier between us. Is that part of your arcane skill?
列昂尼德：我们能够如此顺畅地交流，是否是您所施展的神秘术的作用？

Leonid: By the way, that grain you ate was soaked in liquor, you were passed out drunk when we found you. We mistook you for a strange critter, but then your wand glowed, my colleagues screamed as if a pack of bears or moose had broken loose in our branch again ...
列昂尼德：那些粮食浸过酒，恐怕您是吃醉了。正要将您叫醒的时候，您的骨杖突然亮起，我的同事们吓坏了。他们叫喊得就像上次熊和驼鹿群迷路进了走廊那样……

Leonid: I had to confiscate it for now, and I took your pendant too, just in case.
列昂尼德：所以我擅自做主，将您随身的物件取走，暂时在分部保管了起来。

Yanping: I ... yes, our languages, it's my arcane skill working. I apologize for you finding me in that sorry scene.
燕平：确是如此。抱歉，令你们受了惊吓。

Leonid: More than fine with it, our team didn't suffer any trouble, we've seen worse ... Ah! Here, we are.
列昂尼德：我倒是不在意，毕竟也没什么头痛脑热的……喔，就这儿。

The austere room places metal wherever one might expect wood, leaving the room with a monochromatic gray hue.
方正的金属取代了木质建筑，大多数色彩都被抹去，归为简单的黑、白、灰。

The layout imposes a feeling of strictness and cold.
就像一本每个字都横平竖直，每个词都规矩合辙的簿子。

Combing through the experiences he's witnessed through others' bones, Gětiān can only think of one place that would look this way.
依据过往从族人骨骼上读到的经验，鸟儿只能想到一处类似的场所。

Yanping: Is this a prison?
燕平：此处可是监牢?

Leonid: Haha, you know, I told them to use more colors in the room, but they didn't listen!
列昂尼德：哈哈哈，我早同他们建议过别把房间弄得这样死板！

Leonid: This is, sadly, a bog-standard office of the Foundation. You've caught on to its biggest drawback—it does give the impression of a prison to anyone with even the slightest care for aesthetics.
列昂尼德：您这话实在是说到了点子上，但凡是个活泼的，有正常审美需求的家伙，在这儿大约都是坐牢——瞧，这是基金会办公室。

Leonid: Maybe it's to make us more eager in the field ... Who knows? Please take a seat.
列昂尼德：好在桌椅板凳都有，还是能勉强坐坐的。您请。

He pulls out a chair for the bird, gesturing for him to sit, then sits on the opposite side.
他顺手为鸟儿拉开座椅，又绕到长桌之后坐下。

Something round drops from between his fingers and onto the table.
一枚圆形的小物件从他的手指之间落向桌面。

Leonid: This is a Sharpodonty. Hold it if you want. Just be careful, it might bite you.
列昂尼德：您瞧，这就是利齿子儿。拿起来看也没关系，但要小心别被咬着。

Yanping: It looks similar to the coins I know, only without a hole in the middle.
燕平：倒是与我曾见过的铜钱模样类似，只是铜钱中央并无雕刻。

Yanping: It seems your kind have a preference for cats.
燕平：如此看来，你们似乎很看重猫这种生物。

Leonid: It's a lion, a much larger animal! Imagine a cat larger than this table, with mane and a loud roar.
列昂尼德：它们可比猫要大上不少！这是狮子。您就想象一只比这桌面还要大的生物，而它拥有蓬松的鬃毛，嗓门也大得很。

Leonid: Hey!
列昂尼德：——！您——

Leonid grabs the Sharpodonty immediately and puts it in his pocket.
他眼疾手快地抓起这枚利齿子儿，一把扔进了口袋。

The pocket continues to make a racket of gnashing teeth and ineffectual anger.
即使隔着布料，也能听见它愤怒地将尖牙磨得咯咯直响。

Yanping: This is a splendid coin. It would be most difficult to steal.
燕平：这种钱很好，不易被盗取。

Leonid: Yes, though ... I never thought it would bite you. Usually Sharpodonties only bite humans or when irritated.
列昂尼德：是的，但……我没想到它会咬您，按理说，它们只会尝试咬住人类，或是个别令它们烦躁的家伙。

Leonid: You look like a decent ... bird.
列昂尼德：您看上去可是个文明——呃，鸟。

Yanping: I wonder if a lion likes being petted, like a cat does.
燕平：我本想试试狮子是否像猫一样喜欢被挠痒痒。

He admits to himself, frankly, that he likes being petted too.
他坦然地承认了自己实属后者。

Leonid: You've come a long way from home though, that makes me think you're the curious type.
列昂尼德：好吧，如果不是这点儿好奇在，想必您也不会离开家乡来到这里。

Leonid: Now, before we move on, I must clarify that the Foundation does not intend to violate the privacy of any arcanists.
列昂尼德：在我向您解释之前，我得先声明，基金会并无意探查任何一名神秘学家的个人隐私。

Leonid: The following questions are based on the information I have collected from the Artificial Somnambulism. It's a special circumstance and I hope you understand.
列昂尼德：我与您对谈时所询问的一切，都来自人工梦游所展示的信息。这是特殊情况，希望您理解。

Leonid: To show my sincerity, here's your wand.
列昂尼德：作为诚意的证明，您可以收回您的术杖。

He takes out a long bone stick from a hidden place and pushes towards the awkwardly seated bird.
他不知从何处取出了一支细长的骨制品，推向靠近鸟儿的那侧。

Leonid: You've shown some trust in me, so I think I should trust you in return.
列昂尼德：您展现出了相当的信任，我认为应该有所回报。

Leonid: Few would close their eyes in front of an arcanist they just met without hesitation.
列昂尼德：很少有人会放心地在认识不久的神秘学家面前主动闭上眼。

Yanping: Your bones told me that you are a straightforward person, all deceptions aside.
燕平：你的骨头告诉我，你是行事直接之人。

Yanping: They also say there is something you want from me. That's why you are being so friendly.
燕平：同时，它也告诉我，你向我示好，必有所求。

Gětiān leaves the wand on the table, waiting for Leonid's response patiently.
他并未触碰桌上的骨杖，而是平静地等待着列昂尼德开口。

After all, he received many such offers of kindness from the people beyond his mountain.
毕竟，对鸟儿而言，这是山下人在见到他之后最常做的事。

Whoever they were, they all shared one thing in common: there was always something they wanted.
无论哪处地域，离开族地，便是山下——便无任何差别。

There is always a motive behind a stranger's kindness.
对于并非同族的外来者，任何善意都有其缘由。

Yanping: What do you want? Wealth, fame, social status, or a new arcane skill?
燕平：你要得到什么？钱财、声名、地位，或是从未见过的神秘术？

Yanping: People like you have similar purposes.
燕平：你们所追逐的，向来不外乎此。

6#1
6#1

不同谋
Part Ways CH16603-04

The young man nods, looking much as the bird expected.
正如他所预想那般，年轻人点了点头。

Yet his barrage of questions catches Gětiān off-guard.
他饶有兴致地抛出第一个问题，这问题却远在预料之外。

Leonid: So how might I make this wish? Is there a ritual one needs to perform? And how is it that you grant these wishes?
列昂尼德：那么，我该如何向您许愿？是否有固定的仪式，又会以哪种形式应验？

Leonid: And is it true that you are capable of bringing abundance, like the legendary Firebird?
列昂尼德：您果真拥有使人富饶的能力，就像传说中的火鸟那样？

Leonid: Or are you Koshchei himself, merely hiding in a bird's body?
列昂尼德：又或者您是科西切，借鸟类的躯体在我眼前显现？

Leonid sounds very familiar with these names, his face containing a joyful smile as he mentions them.
他对这些词汇十分熟悉，念诵时还带着笑意。

Leonid: Anyway, whatever creature you are, I would like to ask you for a story.
列昂尼德：这些并不重要，无论您是何种生物，我都要向您请求——我请求一个故事。

Yanping: A story?
燕平：一个故事？

Leonid: Yes, a story you didn't finish.
列昂尼德：没错，您尚未讲完的故事。

Leonid: You told me the backstory of your wand. And it already revealed much about your people. I appreciate you letting me peek into your people's lives like that.
列昂尼德：我听了您骨杖的来由，从中窥见您与您族群存在的少许痕迹，知道在遥远的土地上还有这样活着的生命、如此发生着的事。

Leonid: So I wish that you would finish it. And if you need something in return, I will tell you anything you like, or everything even, so long as it's not classified.
列昂尼德：我想请您讲完它们。如果您需要有所交换，我会为您介绍我知晓，且能够诉说的一切。

Leonid: I enjoy collecting all kinds of stories and finding out the truth behind them, and especially a legend from the Eastern land we know so little about.
列昂尼德：对我个人来说，搜集与验证各种传说是我的兴趣，更何况，这与那个我们所知甚少的东方世界有关。

Leonid: If you're wondering at my motive, your information will undoubtably be important to the Foundation. It may even prove useful for my career.
列昂尼德：甚至进一步讲，这些对基金会也是颇为重要的情报，对我的前途可大有助益。

Yanping: So in the end, you are seeking a higher status.
燕平：你所求，仍是功名。

Leonid: Not truly, no. But, if you'd like to think of it that way, I don't mind.
列昂尼德：好吧，的确是，但也不完全是。

The man shrugs his shoulders, before leaning back in towards Gětiān.
他摊了摊手，似乎对这个结论不甚在意。

Leonid: You were reluctant to leave that mountain in your story, but now here we are talking in this room. Why did you leave? Did your curiosity finally get the better of you?
列昂尼德：您先前的讲述里，说不愿离开那座山，我们如今也还是在这儿互相交谈。难道您不是出于好奇才动身的?

Leonid: Your story will answer my questions, and perhaps my intel could be useful for you in turn.
列昂尼德：您的故事能解答我的疑惑，我所说的或许也能帮上您。

Yanping: I asked myself that question many times. And never arrived on a simple answer ...
燕平：许多年来我都未曾寻获答案，此非易事。

Yanping: But I don't mind giving it a try.
燕平：但一试也无妨。

Yanping: But as you said, we are exchanging information that may be useful to the other, and I have provided some of mine. It's your turn now.
燕平：依你所言，似是要有来有往才好。而我已答完了一些问题，这次不若你先开头。

Leonid: I guess you'll ask me about the Foundation, right?
列昂尼德：我猜，您是要询问基金会相关的事宜?

Yanping: I believe I understand that your "Foundation" is like the "Zhící" in my homeland, an authority at the least.
燕平：我已明了，你所言的“基金会”，便是我来处人们所称的“职祠”。

Yanping: And that your arcane skill is of a rare kind and talent.
燕平：方才你使用的神秘术，却是少见。

Yanping: The image was so real that I hadn't doubted it until the very end. Such a skill could only be the result of generations of cultivation, I'm sure.
燕平：能够营造如此逼真的景象，使得置身其中的人毫无察觉，这是极为古老的术法。

Yanping: But I've only seen it once among the bones I've seen. So where did you learn it from?
燕平：我也只是曾在族人的骨语中，偶然窥见一次——你又如何知晓?

Leonid: I'm afraid I have to disappoint you. What you saw wasn't an arcane skill at all. I don't know that any arcanist in our foundation could do this with arcane skills alone, not even our best.
列昂尼德：请原谅我必须否认您的猜想，我借助的当然不是神秘术。就连总部恐怕也找不出几个能施放这种神秘术的天才。

Leonid: No, what you saw here was produced by a machine, given a little ingenuity on our part. Though I admit, it probably looks like magic to most people.
列昂尼德：这只是机器和一些理论知识共同构造的小小机关，要我说，它是个“平民的奇迹”。

Leonid: Officially, it's called "Artificial Somnambulism."
列昂尼德：它的正式名称是“人工梦游”。

Yanping: Yes, I remember, you mentioned it before.
燕平：这样说来，你的确提到过这个词。

Leonid: The city, the old man, and the ladies I asked you about were all produced from your memories. Your subconscious tricked you into rationalizing what you saw as real.
列昂尼德：城中景象、老者与那几位我向您询问的少女，都是您曾见过的人与事。是您的大脑，您的潜意识自动将一切合理化了。

Leonid: Essentially, you built the dream around yourself, so it's only natural that you believed it was real.
列昂尼德：根本上说来，这是您自己造的梦，自然不会有太多破绽。

The bird tries to match Leonid's words with his experiences.
鸟儿试图用自己的理解来诠释这些刚刚接触的词汇。

This machine must be some kind of mechanical device.
机器，用金属所造的各种机关。

And his subconsciousness must refer to the impressions of one's own mind.
潜意识，应当是指他内心所想。

And if that is the case, the function of this "Artificial Somnambulism" becomes obvious.
这样一来，“人工梦游”所能做的也十分显明了。

Yanping: So this device reads one's mind and creates an illusion using replicas built from one's own memories. In a way, it functions quite similar to the arcane skill I had seen before.
燕平：便是读人心思，再以此为摹本制造幻境。其原理与那术法是同样的。

Leonid: From the sounds of it, yes, but please don't be alarmed.
列昂尼德：从结果上说的确如此，但您不必担心。

Leonid: The Artificial Somnambulism Guidance has specified the scope of content that operators are allowed to access. We can't see the parts of your mind that you refuse to show, not that we would ever try. It would be a severe violation of one's personal rights, after all.
列昂尼德：《人工梦游使用守则》之中的条例详细规定了操作者所能查看的内容范围。我们不会，也无法查看您不愿公开的记忆与思想。那是严重侵犯个人权益的行为。

Leonid: You're a rare case, I had access to that entire city and all those people in your mind. Not to imply you are careless, but it seems you trust others easily.
列昂尼德：我之所以能看到如此多的内容，是因为您是少有的那一小部分。您并非毫无防备，但却似乎天然地对其他人抱有极大信任。

Leonid: I guess your hometown has a friendly and tolerant atmosphere.
列昂尼德：想必您生长的土地具有友善与包容的美德。

Yanping: No ... Not exactly.
燕平：也不尽然。

Yanping: That's one of the reasons why I left the mountain.
燕平：这正是促使我下山的诸多原因之一。

Yanping: Much of what I know comes from my people's bones, but there is a limit to what I can learn. I cannot know what they've forgotten or what they refuse to tell.
燕平：我所知的多是来自于骨头上读到的信息，但族人未曾记住，或不愿讲的，我自然也无从了解。

Yanping: But I find myself more than a little confused as we continue our conversation.
燕平：如今见到你，倒是越发使我困惑。

Yanping: You desire something, yet refuse to admit it. You invented a method to read people's mind, yet impose so many restrictions on it.
燕平：你们分明有所期望，却执着否认。寻找窥探人心的方式，却又要用各种规则将其限制。

Yanping: When my people left the mountain, humans begged them to grant their wishes, yet at the same time, they suspected my people of evil intentions.
燕平：我的族人下山后，山下人一边相信他们会回应所求，又一边认为他们是另有居心的异族。

Yanping: When my kind were still alive, some humans thought we were sent by their deities, while others grew bitter, thinking our help was demeaning.
燕平：他们生时，有人满心感谢，认为这是某种神灵的帮助，有人怨恨他们，认为这是高高在上的施舍。

Yanping: And as we died out, one by one, some cheered and some cried ...
燕平：他们死后，有人拍手叫好，却也有人为他们哀声恸哭。

Yanping: Now, I sense you have no intention to push me, yet you are not going to let me go either. You try to be nice and show sincerity, yet I sense a nervousness at my every movement.
燕平：你不曾因我的过错刁难于我，却也并无轻易放我离去的打算；摆出诚恳的态度，却又时时因我的举动而倍感紧张。

Yanping: It seems you humans really are ... inconsistent.
燕平：由此看来，正如我所想，山下人都是这般矛盾。

Yanping: But what I do not understand is what this has to do with my homeland ...
燕平：——可这又与土地有何相干?

Leonid: Inconsistent? Aha, yes, I suppose we can be ... but most people never question their own inconsistencies.
列昂尼德：正是！这世上的人们，到底都极为相似，为的就是那一口饱饭，能过上相对舒适的日子！

Leonid: But, I know this is no small question for you, and that's why I think we're in a position to help each other.
列昂尼德：这么一来，我们奔着的倒的确是同一个方向——您不懂这矛盾的来由，我对您的族群也还不甚了解。

Leonid: If you tell me more about your home, then I'll have more of the information I need, and then maybe we can work out just why it is we humans can be so inconsistent.
列昂尼德：听了您讲的故事，我能帮您略做分析，您也能提供我要的信息。

Leonid: It's likely not every detail will be useful, but why not give it a try?
列昂尼德：我们告诉彼此的东西都不一定真能派上用场，但就像您说的：为什么不试试呢?

The young man leans forward again, like pressing a weight against the bird, hoping for a response.
年轻人的目光比之前更为坚定，他微微向前倾身，等待着回答。

Gětiān takes notice at that moment, that the young man's neck bones shine brighter whenever he mentions the legend from the east.
在鸟儿看来，每当他谈及那些传说，他咽喉处的骨节便随着呼吸亮起。

And now they are practically glowing.
而眼下正是它们最为明亮的时刻。

Leonid: Please.
列昂尼德：我请求您。

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

Leonid: I hope to hear everything that happened somewhere far away from here, and in the name of Leonid, I swear I will never use the story for any evil purposes.
列昂尼德：以我个人的名义起誓，我希望尽可能地听取在远方发生的一切，但绝不以此行恶事。

Leonid: I know that word-of-mouth doesn't always ring true and that a story told from just one perspective can never give a full impression ...
列昂尼德：或许这样口口相传的故事，未必能落到实处，甚至对多数人来说并无价值。就像一些……过于遥远的幽灵。

Leonid: But I can't stop myself from chasing this story to its end.
列昂尼德：但我不可能抑制住想了解它们的心情，先生。

The man's driving curiosity might have come off too strong, if Gětiān hadn't felt it himself before.
这就是好奇心了。鸟儿明白这种感受。

His race's arcane skill allowed them to read other creatures' minds, yet the animals of the mountain had little occupying their minds except their daily survival.
辨识骨相的能力使他的族群能明白周围生物的所思所想，而鸟兽所关注的只是吃食、玩耍与休憩。

The birds didn't truly understand what being curious was like until they found a race with minds more like their own. Creatures that could communicate using words, that could invent and imagine new things.
直到他们发现另一种生灵，与自己外形相仿，能够对话交流，能够创造出从未曾见的物件。

From this race, the birds learned how to use fire and how to write down their thoughts, and finally they learned to be curious.
从这些生灵身上，他们学到了掌控火焰的方式，习得了文字，也因此——愈发好奇。

Now the bird suddenly realizes what he and the young man share in common.
直到此时，他忽然隐约察觉出自己与对方的共同之处。

Yanping: What attracts you is not necessarily good for you.
燕平：令你追逐之物，未必于你有益。

He held in a sigh.
这几乎是一声叹息。

Leonid: I see, but never knowing would be even worse for me.
列昂尼德：我明白您的意思，但没有什么比一无所知更令人畏惧。

Yanping: Very well. I already interpreted a Hexagram for my friends before I came here. It said, "One should go with the flow."
燕平：罢了。我动身前曾与友人解卦，略作阐释。卦象所言，道是应顺其自然。

Yanping: So, I have decided that I will just "go with the flow."
燕平：就说与你听。

Yanping: You haven't returned my pendant yet. Shall we start from there?
燕平：我随身的玉佩，你还未归还。是否要由此谈起?

Leonid: I'm listening, and with great anticipation, let me say.
列昂尼德：您愿意讲，是我的荣幸。

Yanping: In fact, its former owner was a bit like you.
燕平：玉佩的原主，倒与你有些相似之处。

Leonid: Really? I'm honored you'd say so ...
列昂尼德：这，好吧，这也是我的荣幸。

The young man cuts his reply short, prodding the bird to continue.
年轻人飞快地接上话，生怕让句子落了地。

Yanping: But I suppose, when I think back on it ... it seems a trait that all humans share.
燕平：但仔细想来，我所记得的山下人都是这般。

Gětiān glances at the young man, tilting his head.
鸟儿瞥了他一眼，偏了偏脑袋。

Leonid can sense there is a compliment behind the bird's expression. As if he were an old man rustling a boy's hair with a smile.
列昂尼德能从对方的神情里读出称赞，仿若长辈在赞许后辈行事机灵，又仿若一个小小的玩笑。

Leonid: ...
列昂尼德：……

Leonid: Could I ask how old you are? I don't know how to tell how old a bird looks, but you don't seem ... old.
列昂尼德：实在冒犯了，我忘记询问您的年纪——您看上去不太像一位长者。

Leonid: So ... would you be, say ... my father's age?
列昂尼德：您……论年岁来说，应该算是我的父辈?

Yanping: No. Likely, not.
燕平：这倒错了。

Leonid: Don't tell me you're as old as my grandfather!
列昂尼德：总不会是祖父的年纪!

Yanping: I'm much older than your great-great-grandfather, I'm afraid.
燕平：恐怕比你们所称的祖父之祖，还要年长许多。

Leonid: ...!
列昂尼德：——!

The young man's confusion seems more natural to his face than his smile.
这副疑惑的表情比年轻人方才的笑容更为真实。

Taking a deep breath, the bird begins to tell the story.
趁他猛抽一口气的当口，鸟儿为故事开了个头。

Yanping: This jade pendant belonged to two others before it came to me.
燕平：这枚玉佩，到我手中时，已换了三任主人。

6#1
6#1

身非木石
Heart of Flesh CH16603-05

Yanping: In my homeland, the people living under the mountain had a preference for jade wares.
燕平：我所生活之处，山下的人们多喜好玉器。

Yanping: I can only scarcely remember when those delicate jade pendants first came into fashion in the city. They resembled their coins; rounded, with a hole in the center.
燕平：也不知由何时起，他们随身佩戴的饰物越发精巧，那枚圆形小物件恰似铜钱，又不尽然相同。

Yanping: Some were glossy green, others pale white. They would feel warm if kept close to the body.
燕平：它能很容易地被体温烘暖，表面光润，拥有如叶片般的翠色，或是卵石般的白净外表。

Yanping: Perhaps that's why it was worth so much.
燕平：这或许是它贵重的缘由。

Yanping: I first saw it on the belt of a scholar.
燕平：第一次见到这块玉佩时，它悬在一名书生腰间。

Scholar: ... I ... pray ...
书生：……我……祈求……

Scholar: ... keep us safe ... in this place ...
书生：保佑我们……在此……

Yanping: What is that ...?
燕平：这是……?

He raises his head from behind his wings and to look down through the leaves.
鸟儿将脑袋从翅膀间抬起，借着树叶的缝隙向下探看。

This is not the first time he has heard a human here.
他早已见惯这副景象。

Yanping: Another seeker of blessings.
燕平：又是来求平安的人。

Yanping: I wonder why they put so much trust in the power of this tree ...
燕平：究竟从何起的传言，叫他们竟都信了这树有些神通。

Yanping: Perhaps they do this simply for peace of mind. I suppose it doesn't matter.
燕平：求助于外物，不过寻个寄托而已。也罢。

Citizen: Good day to you, young master. I've seen you up here a lot of late.
城中居民：小郎君又到此来了？最近总见着你往这山上跑，也是累人哩。

Citizen: Here to pray for the exam? You have shown good devotion. The tree fairy will surely look after you.
城中居民：是为你那科举求个榜上有名么？你心思诚，想必树仙会看顾你的。

Scholar: I can only hope to be so blessed.
书生：若真蒙树仙照拂，那便再好不过。

Scholar: I come here to pray every day, but I do so just to reassure myself, in case I become too nervous in the exam to remember what I have learned.
书生：我日日来此，其实也只是求个心安，以免应试时慌张，记不起平时所学。

Citizen: You ought to play some music underneath the tree.
城中居民：那末你便试一试在这树下奏乐，如何?

Citizen: People say they hear songs coming down from the tree, but no one has ever seen any bird or man playing it. We figure it's a fairy.
城中居民：大家都道，曾听着枝叶间有乐声传来，仰头却又不见人影，连飞鸟也无。想来只能是仙人在此了。

Citizen: And if you play music to please her, the fairy might give you her blessings.
城中居民：仙人好乐韵，你便以此相求，正算合宜呢。

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

Getian never expected he'd be the cause of a superstition.
鸟儿从未想过传言竟是因自己而起。

He had just learned a song from the bones. It had been a quiet day, and he was practicing.
他刚从一块时常哼歌的骨头那儿学得些奏乐技巧，想是树上安静，便偶尔来此习练。

Who would have thought it could be so misconstrued?
谁知误打误撞地让人听去，又传成了这般模样。

Scholar: Wouldn't I be ... swaying the fairy's judgment if I did so?
书生：这……这恐怕有些取巧。

Scholar: I should just say my wishes as they are. Then it's the fairy's choice to grant them or not.
书生：我还是将我所求的如实相告，若神灵愿听，甚好。不愿听，也只当我叨扰了。

They converse for a little longer, until the second voice begins to fade away.
树底的说话声又持续了一阵，随即渐渐低下去。

Now the only voice is the one which woke him from his dream.
少顷，只剩那个将鸟儿唤醒的声音。

Scholar: I wish for the people here to live a life of peace, safe from disaster, and that their hard work will be rewarded with bountiful harvests ...
书生：……还望在此居住的百姓平安，令那水患止息，不至害了收成……

Scholar: ... that merchants will be safe on their journeys ...
书生：往来商贸……皆能通畅……

Yanping: His wishes are all about others.
燕平：求了这许久，尽是他人之事。

Yanping: How curious ...
燕平：也是奇怪。

He loses himself momentarily in thought before casting another glance down to him.
他想到这里，不禁又打起精神，仔细瞧了一眼。

Yanping: That backbone ... He may make a good counselor in the court.
燕平：这脊骨，此后倒是位不错的谏臣……

He rarely read other creatures' bones outside of his own people.
自从学会控制这种天赋，他几乎再未主动读过族人以外的骨相。

Bone reading so often makes one curious; and curiosity in turn could be the cause of many troubles.
不去窥探，便可免于好奇。

Even when he wanted to read another creature's bones, he would inevitably talk himself out of it.
若难得动了这份想瞧个究竟的心思，也多要说服自己不必涉入他人的因果。

He tries, with some difficulty, to not make this an exception.
这次也并无例外。

Yanping: Pity he will live a disturbed life. Over-righteousness often comes with misfortune.
燕平：只可惜，过刚易折，一生落于坎坷。

Yanping: He will die for his beliefs. I cannot help but wonder if it might be a ...
燕平：为所执而死，仔细想来，也……

Yanping: ... No. It's none of my concern.
燕平：……但又与我何干呢。

Gětiān pulls back his glance from the man and his bones.
他收回目光，不再关注那段明亮的骨头。

But the voice inches closer.
直到那声音骤然接近。

Scholar: I must set out tomorrow.
书生：明日我就要动身了。

Scholar: Let me see. I don't have anything valuable, actually. I'll just leave this here, as a token of sincerity.
书生：这身上……也并无什么值钱的物件，就将它留下，且表诚意吧。

Scholar: I promise to return with better offerings to show my gratitude, well, if my wishes come true that is ...
书生：若是真应了我的心愿，我再回来，还上一还。

Yanping: ...
燕平：……

As the man approaches the tree, the bird withdraws more deeply into its leaves.
鸟儿放轻动作，收紧翅膀，好让自己混入叶片之中。

There is a rustling of fabric and grass. Something is put on the ground.
他只隐约听到书生放下了什么东西。

Scholar: Right. This ... should do it.
书生：好。如此……便够了。

Scholar: Farewell.
书生：改日再会。

Gětiān cannot dare to look until all is quiet again.
待树下彻底恢复寂静，鸟儿才再次低头查看。

Below him now is a jade pendant. The same that had hung on the young man's belt.
原先悬在书生腰间的玉佩，此刻正躺在地面。

The bird ponders for a moment and puts it into the tree's hollow.
他想了一想，替它换了一处位置。

Yanping: Nobody will look inside the tree's hollow. It's safer here.
燕平：恰好，这棵槐树的树洞还算隐蔽，不易被寻到。

Yanping: And should he come back to look for it, I will find a way to return it to him.
燕平：若他果真回来取，再想个法子还与他就是。

Yanping: What is lost must be returned, so one may be spared unwanted troubles.
燕平：物归原主，应当不牵涉因果。

The thought puts his mind at ease. And he returns to his sleep.
鸟儿在枝头仔细考量着，得出使自己安心的结论，便再次睡去。

Yanping: After the young scholar left, life in the forest became quiet again. I spent many long hours in that tree, napping or just listening to the wind.
燕平：其后，我仍是过着栖在槐树之上，听风打盹的日子。

Yanping: But the scholar never returned.
燕平：书生再未回到此地。

Yanping: Perhaps it is just as his bones foretold; and he was taken by death young.
燕平：想来他是如我所见一般，落得个早逝的结局。

Yanping: Even if I was wrong, mortal lives are short. The pendant no longer had a master.
燕平：若我看错，山下之人寿命本也短暂。恐怕这块玉佩已沦为无主之物。

Yanping: Until I met its second owner.
燕平：但最后，我等到了它的第二任主人。

Scholar's Son: So this is the tree Father mentioned. It's more flourishing than I imagined.
书生儿子：这就是父亲曾提起的那棵树。比我所想的还要枝叶繁茂。

Scholar's Son: I wouldn't be surprised if there truly was a fairy here.
书生儿子：要说有仙人居住也不令人意外。

Yanping: I hadn't seen many blessing-seekers for some time. It seemed now that people only gathered under the tree to talk and laugh before parting ways.
燕平：最近前来的人，连平安也不曾求了，只为了来此吵闹一阵。

Yanping: Humans ...
燕平：实在无趣……

Yanping: Hmm?
燕平：嗯?

Seeing this young man recalls a similar scene.
鸟儿很快就从记忆中寻得了相似的场景。

His bones are strangely similar to those of the young scholar who visited so many years ago.
眼前少年人的骨相，与那位书生几乎全然相同。

He foresees that this man too will meet a similar end.
这也意味着他们会走向同一个结局。

Yanping: I thought people in the outside world cherished their lives more than anything. How come he would rather die than stand by? It's meaningless.
燕平：山下之人如此惜取光阴，难道不知以死相逼最为无用么？

Yanping: Risking your life just to say something that might not even be adopted. How reckless! It's not worth it.
燕平：撞个头破血流，只为讲出一句未必落到实处的话，莽撞可惜。

Yanping: Is this necessary?
燕平：……何须如此。

For him, spending so much time in this tree, well perhaps it's merely habit ... But this is where the humans come to make their wishes.
他停在这棵槐树上，一是出于习惯，另也是为在闲暇时听取人们所求诸事。

And he listens to their requests, trying to understand what draws his race to them.
或许从这些纷杂愿望中，能找到吸引族人们的那点特殊之处。

He no longer blames his people for leaving home behind. Still, he is puzzled.
多年来，他并无责备，只是不解。

... Why did you go into the human world? Why did you sacrifice yourself?
——为何下山？为何赴死？

Scholar's Son: Father, the places you used to talk about, I visited them all.
书生儿子：父亲，您提过的去处，我已一一看了。

Scholar's Son: You warned me not to follow in your footsteps. But I chose this path on my own.
书生儿子：您虽告诫我，切莫步了您的后尘，可我也有自己的决断。

Scholar's Son: Besides, I have already seen the beauty of the world. I can't bear to watch it being ruined.
书生儿子：何况见过天地间好风光，就更不忍眼见它倾颓。

Gětiān listens silently from the treetop.
树梢之上，鸟儿静静听着这番剖白。

This had been the moment to return the pendant.
这或许是归还玉佩的最好时机。

Scholar's Son: Such a beautiful tree should stay here alone, so it won't be destroyed.
书生儿子：这样一棵树，还是独自长在此处，才不必担心被摧折。

Scholar's Son: Enough empty words. I've made up my mind.
书生儿子：话也说尽了，就这样罢。

The young man walks away with determination. Never looking back.
脚步声离去得迅速，方向明确，行得踏实、果断。

The bird knows at that moment he will never see him again.
鸟儿明白，这位少年人再没有回头的机会。

From then on, he found himself returning to the hollow to check on the pendant.
此后，他时常查看那枚树洞之中的玉佩。

Within a few short days his prediction appears to come true.
——也不过几日光景，他所读命数便如期应验。

Yanping: As I thought.
燕平： 果然。

Yanping: What could he have gained from this desperate course of action?
燕平： ……这般孤注一掷，又有何用。

Yanping: ...
燕平： ……

The jade, now broken, seems like little more than a mound of pebbles. But the bird picks them up.
玉碎之后，便与杂物无异。但鸟儿并不为这些世间的标准所扰，收起了散落的碎片。

Yanping: I tried to repair it. Doing the best I could, afterward I tied it to the end of my bone flute.
燕平： 我试着用所学将这块玉佩修复，系在骨笛之上。

Yanping: I thought maybe I would come to understand them more by repairing the jade.
燕平： 当时，我认为或许能借此寻得一些解释。

Yanping: They struggled for what they knew was impossible, and even died for it unknowingly, just like my people.
燕平： 他们明知不可为而为，因所求而无声息地死。与我的同族何其相似。

Yanping: Not long after that, a strange rumor went around the village—that people there were being mysteriously turned into horses.
燕平： 不久后，山下之民遭逢人为变形这等无妄之灾，一时间，人心惶惶。

Yanping: I decided to find out what really happened.
燕平： 我决定前去察看。

Yanping: Turns out I am also part of the story.
燕平： 这故事……原来是我自己的因果。

6#1
6#1

壶中天
The Limited Sky in the Teapot CH16603-06

Leonid: So you repaired the pendant ... that's why it has these cracks?
列昂尼德： 原来这些裂痕是修补后留下的。

Leonid: I wouldn't have thought it possible with just a pair of wings. Holding it at a distance, you can hardly tell it was broken.
列昂尼德： 我真想不到您是怎样用翅膀将它补得这样好。稍微拿远些看……几乎瞧不出任何缝隙。

Following his gaze down, the bird's eyes spot the jade lying on the table.
鸟儿也循着他的视线打量着桌面上的玉佩。

Yanping: I have not checked it carefully in a very long time. Judging from the look, I might have spent a lot of effort on it indeed.
燕平： 我很久不曾再仔细瞧过它。今日再观，当时应是费了许多心思。

Yanping: I felt something change inside me, after seeing what happened to the previous owners of the pendant. So when I left the mountain, I kept it as a reminder.
燕平：决定下山，有这故事的几分触动所致。因此借玉佩权作提醒。

Leonid: Not to meddle in others' affairs?
列昂尼德：是为提醒自己，千万别干涉其他人的命运?

Yanping: And to remind myself how similar my people and humans really are ...
燕平：也为时时想起两族相似之处。

Leonid: I wasn't favored by the goddess of wisdom. So please forgive me if I say anything stupid or offensive.
列昂尼德：同您比起来，我的见识实在少得可怜，要是说错了什么话，您别见怪。

Softly and tentatively, he touches the edge of the pendant with his fingertips. Then he sits up.
他试探地抚摸着玉佩的边缘，随后松开手，坐直身子。

Leonid: It feels a little like a piece of bone. Speaking of which, I wonder what you can see from my bones ... No. Never mind. I don't think I want to know.
列昂尼德：它摸起来和骨头也挺相似。说起来，我还不知道您从我身上这副骨头看出了些什么——算了，您可千万别告诉我。

Leonid: At first, I thought it was a trick for detecting lies and illusions. But if it's my past and future that you are seeing, count me out.
列昂尼德：起初我还以为您只是能借此探查谎言，要是能把我的现在、过去、未来都一并瞧个清楚，那我可一点都不好奇了。

Leonid: I would lose interest in living my life if I find out that I won't die surrounded by my collections of stories and beautifully carved bones.
列昂尼德：如果我的结局不是死在自己收集来的故事堆里，手边也没有精细的骨雕，我现在就会失去求生意志。

Yanping: I haven't looked that closely.
燕平：我并未看得这样多。

Leonid: You "haven't"! But it IS within your abilities to pry into the details. Please don't tell anyone what you see, including me. Clamp it, muzzle it! Oh ... Pardon me. I only mean your ability is very impressive. Yes. That's all I wanted to say.
列昂尼德：“并未”！那您是能做到的了！请您务必对看到的内容守口如瓶，要比蜡封了嘴巴还严实。噢，原谅我有些粗俗的措辞，这实在有些……惊人。是的，惊人。

Yanping: You flatter me, sir.
燕平：你的感想很有趣。

Yanping: But life beyond the mountain has told me much more than what the bones may tell. My people must have felt the same as they traveled across the human world.
燕平：离开后，我在山下所见，的确远胜于借由骨头所读到的一切。

Yanping: They thought themselves visitors to that world, only traveling through it, little did they know that they were already bound to it.
燕平：或许我的族人也只是偶然遭逢，只打算看过便罢。

Yanping: But things are connected once they meet each other.
燕平：打了照面，便有了牵绊。

Yanping: Novelty attracts attention, and it is all too easy to get obsessed with finding it.
燕平：如你所说，新奇之物向来令人瞩目。若是仔细琢磨，往往陷于其中。

Yanping: I learned calligraphy, drawing, music instruments ... so many other skills. I have also learned many poems, all thanks to chasing novelty.
燕平：我便是这样习得了书画、乐器、诸多工艺，也背下了不少诗文典籍。

Leonid: I started carving bones after I got this very knife.
列昂尼德：我了解骨雕技艺也是因为买到了一柄漂亮的小刀。

Leonid: Actually, the bone piece embedded in the blade will shine like a pearl if you put it under the light ... but there's no doubt it's bone. It even looks alive when you put it in fire ... I just can't stop looking at it.
列昂尼德：您不知道，它刀身镶嵌的薄骨片，让灯一照就有珍珠和贝母般的光泽……可它却是骨头。在火底下，它简直像活的……于是我再难以挪开目光。

Leonid: Do your people know how to do it?
列昂尼德：您的族人也可能是在无意中发觉了这件事。

Yanping: Do what?
燕平：何事?

Leonid: Imbue things with life.
列昂尼德：令死物复活的技艺。

Leonid: Wood, bones, metal, mud ... We may shape them into the forms of animals and men—this is one way of bringing them to life.
列昂尼德：木头、骨头、金属或是泥土，用它们塑出生物的外形，这是一种。

Leonid: The other way is ... to give them stories.
列昂尼德：往物件中灌注故事，这是另一种。

Leonid: When I first saw your bone wand and the jade pendant, I assumed that the wand was more precious than the pendant, because it has arcane power, and the pendant doesn't.
列昂尼德：先前见到您的骨杖和玉佩时，我理所当然地想着，自然是带有神秘术气息的物件更贵重。

Leonid: But now, I'm more drawn in to your pendant's story.
列昂尼德：但听完您所讲的，我再见到它们，记起的，却只有您说的话了。

Leonid: Items with stories are more valuable than those without.
列昂尼德：载有故事的物件自然不可代替，它们比空白时更具价值。

Yanping: Indeed.
燕平：是一桩道理。

Leonid: And to fully master a skill, one must first find a good teacher, and then be willing to search the world to learn more ...
列昂尼德：接触掌握技艺的人，才能有机会习得它。但，您瞧。在这过程中，又生出许多新的经历……

He stops himself.
年轻人骤然打住了话头。

Leonid: Oh. Sorry, I should get some water. Or would you like tea? I'm going to brew some anyway.
列昂尼德：喔——抱歉，我有些口渴。您从东方来，应该有饮茶的习惯吧。正好，正好。

Leonid: The branch just bought some new samovars. I'll make some tea for us.
列昂尼德：分部刚添了一批茶炊，我先煮上。

A shiny tea set now fills up most of the space on the desk. The young man bends down to carefully light the charcoal beneath the device.
外壳锃亮的器皿占据了桌面绝大部分空间，年轻人正细心地为其点火。

Yanping: How convenient. The pot must come from a good designer.
燕平：此物便利，设计者是位巧匠。

Leonid: My people are heavy tea-drinkers, so samovars were invented to meet our needs. It's very convenient, it pours easily and provides much needed wind protection to keep the tea warm. There's even a place to set snacks on.
列昂尼德：原先没有这样的工具，我们喝茶喝得多了，就自然有了许多要求——为茶保温，要防风，要便利，随手就能取来用，最好还能便于放置配茶用的糕饼点心。

Leonid: You see, no one would have been bothered to design such a thing if tea weren't introduced to us.
列昂尼德：不过，要是不知道有茶叶这样东西，就不会有工匠去研究茶炊。

The glistening, amber tea is poured out of the pot until it fills the cup. As the steam rises, drops of water condense on the tips of the bird's feathers.
杯中逐渐盛满琥珀色的茶汤，热气蒸腾，在鸟儿的羽翼侧面结出一串水珠。

Leonid: If there are needs, there will be those who try to meet those needs.
列昂尼德：可一但知道，总会有工匠去尝试。

Leonid: It's true, once you have a prototype, others will try to improve on it. But ...
列昂尼德：他们掌握了制作茶炊的工艺，就会希望有所改进。

Leonid: The "creation" is the real exciting part.
列昂尼德：“创造”才是其中真正令人上瘾的成分。

The bird ruminates on the word.
鸟儿咀嚼着这个词。

The young man is right. His people have never developed any skills or invented anything—not even the smallest things which might make their lives easier, like this tea pot.
他与族人的确不曾研究出什么新的技艺，或是这种便利的物件。

All they have ever done is imitation or mimicry.
他们所做的更多是摹仿。

They spent years learning human languages, imitating their behaviors, and adapting to their customs. The bones of their predecessors, recording all the information they would need.
摹仿山下人的语言、文字、行为。摹仿死去的族人所记取的内容，为此耗费漫长的时间。

Yanping: Neither I nor any of my people have ever "created" anything.
燕平：我与族人都不曾创造过任何东西。

Yanping: If imitation was what we left the mountain for, we probably chose the wrong path at the very beginning.
燕平：若就是它使得我们下山……大概从最开始我们就找错了方向。

Yanping: It's meaningless.
燕平：徒劳而已。

He puts an end to this thought.
鸟儿为自己的疑问画上了一个简单的注脚。

It's a conclusion he never thought he would make, but not one he never thought about before.
这是恰好穿过针眼的那根线，适时撞响的钟声，他从未想到，又早有准备的答案。

Leonid: Don't overthink it! True invention is rare, only a small number of people ever manage it. There are as few of them as an old man's hair!
列昂尼德：您想得太多了！能发明茶炊的人只是那么一小撮——就像猫背上几根抖擞的毛发那样！

Leonid: Someone else invented it, and now all I have to do is make the tea.
列昂尼德：有人做出茶炊，我就买来煮茶。

Yanping: Anyone can make tea.
燕平： 人人都能煮茶。

Leonid: True, true ... but we all brew our tea a little differently. Each taste is unique.
列昂尼德： 但别人可未必能煮出我喜欢的口味。

Leonid: I have to say, your dogged pursuit of an explanation reminds me of some of my other arcanist friends ...
列昂尼德： 您这股爱往死胡同闯的劲儿还真像极了刻板印象里的神秘学家……

Leonid: I don't know how to make a wand as simple and natural as yours; likewise, you can't make tea as good as mine. Things like this happen all the time. It's not a big deal.
列昂尼德： 我雕不出您那根朴素自然的骨杖，您煮不出我这杯拿手的茶。事情就是这样，没什么大不了的。

Leonid: There's no need to dwell on the true reason you left the mountain. Maybe it was just curiosity. It could be anything!
列昂尼德： 让您挂念的那个原因，把它归为好奇心也好，说成是其他也成。

Leonid: Or perhaps you were looking for a tool to survive.
列昂尼德： 你们大概是想寻得某种途径吧。

Yanping: We don't need any new tools, my people have always had what we needed to survive.
燕平： 对能勘察骨相的“仙人”而言，交流并非难事，无需寻觅途径。

Leonid: Now, now. With that mindset, you're sure to find yourself at a dead end. How could I make tea without a samovar? You'll have to see more to know what you're capable of, what you're made to do! That's your "tool."
列昂尼德： 瞧，您又一次飞进了死胡同！有了茶炊，我才能煮茶——见过足够多的东西，你们才知道什么是仅有自己能做的。

The young man shakes his head a little, and takes a sip from his cup. His face wrinkling up in disgust.
年轻人摆了摆手，喝了一口热茶，五官立刻滑稽地皱成了团。

Leonid: *spits the tea out* It's bitter!
列昂尼德： 呸、呸呸！该死，怎么这样苦！

Leonid: Don't ... Oh, good that you haven't had any. Too many tea leaves in one pot, I'd say!
列昂尼德： 您——您还没尝，真是万幸——一定是茶叶放得太多，该死！

Leonid: I'll make you another one.
列昂尼德： 我马上替您重新煮一壶，立刻就去……

Yanping: No matter. Allow me.
燕平： 无妨，我来便可。

Leonid: ... Oh ... Well ... Thank you.
列昂尼德： ……哦，这真是……谢谢您。

Yanping: Sugar or honey?
燕平： 糖还是蜜?

Leonid: Honey, please. That's how we had it back in the village.
列昂尼德： 我家的村子里用蜂蜜更多。

The bird nods in understanding. He stares at the tea pot and slightly lifts his wings. The bronze pot tilts as he moves, and deftly fills their cups.
鸟儿点了点头，凝视着桌上的器皿，稍稍抬起羽翼。铜制小壶随之自动倾斜，注满水杯。

Leonid: Oh, and please pour my tea here, into the plate.
列昂尼德： 噢，我的那份请倒在这儿，茶碟里边。

As he waits for his tea, the young man scoops up some honey and sends it into his mouth. Then he takes up his plate, drinking the tea from its edge.
他舀一勺蜜糖送入口中，托起瓷碟，从边缘吮着茶汤。

Yanping: I've never seen one drink tea in this manner before.
燕平： 这样的喝法我却是头回见。

Leonid: You'll get used to it if you stick around. We don't have rules on how people should drink their tea here.
列昂尼德： 您要是还打算在这里停留几日，恐怕早晚会习惯。大家喝茶图个热闹愉快，都拣最顺手的办法。

Yanping: Indeed, it's good to learn new things.
燕平： 也好，又是一样新见识。

The white steam from the hot tea rises, and they both fall into a comfortable silence.
壶中的热气冉冉上升，室内的人与物都陷入温和的、短暂的停滞。

Slowly, the steam gathers until it hangs in the air like fog. As Leonid realizes he no longer can see Gětiān's face, nor the wall behind him.
蒸汽化作成团白雾，年轻人隔着这层白色望去，逐渐看不清鸟儿的面目，也瞧不见冰冷但可靠的墙壁。

But there is still a wall, only it's no longer the staid gray office walls he knew.
或者说，那并非他所熟悉的墙壁。

Leonid: What is going on?!
列昂尼德： 什么——?!

Leonid: You said you don't know anything about Artificial Somnambulism. So how did you gain access to it? You ...
列昂尼德： 您起初说您不了解人工梦游！这不符合我所知的操作规范，您从哪儿弄来的权限！您——

Yanping: I have no such device in my possession. I spoke truly, I had never experienced its effects before.
燕平： 我并无“权限”，也的确是第一次体验它。

Yanping: But I did tell you of an arcane skill similar to it. Have you forgotten?
燕平： 几刻前我告知你，我见过与它相仿的神秘术。你难道这便忘记了?

Leonid: ...
列昂尼德： ……

Leonid: It's my job to assess whether you are a threat to the Foundation. To do that, I had to keep certain information from you. We only want honest answers from you, that's all.
列昂尼德： 判断您是否具有威胁，这是我的职责。如果过早地让您知晓这点，您的回答就会丧失相当的可信度。相信我们都不愿看到这种结果。

Leonid: Now ... You're right, we are still dreaming. That was the last piece of information I kept from you.
列昂尼德： 现在……我们的确还在人工梦游之内。这是我对您隐瞒的唯一内容。

Leonid: If you're upset ...
列昂尼德： 如果您对此感到……

Yanping: I knew what you wanted since the beginning.
燕平： 我早知你的意图。

The bird's voice is calm as he continues.
鸟儿平淡地陈述着这一事实。

Yanping: Yet, I was bewildered by the inconsistency between your words and your deeds.
燕平：因此，我才实在不解你们的矛盾之举。

Yanping: I have also learned much from our conversation. But as I was once told, it is best to judge the heart by its deeds.
燕平：但先前的交谈也令我有些收获。我想，如你所说，亲眼所见之物最是动人。

Yanping: ... Which is why I'm taking control.
燕平：……于是，才借机带你一观。

6#1
6#1

歧路无多
No More Astray CH16603-07

Leonid: Turns out I was the one who was left in the dark ...
列昂尼德：这幅光景，转眼就在我自己身上上演了啊。

Leonid: Now I wonder why you let me guide you into these dreams. Weren't you afraid? As I'm afraid now. The Foundation won't go easy on me if they find out you operated the machine without training! And what if anything goes wrong, and we're stuck in here forever?
列昂尼德：也不知您当时是如何肯放心的，我现在便十分担忧，怕的是要受责备，又总紧张着您是头一回用人工梦游，要是将机器弄坏，我们全得关在里头……

Yanping: You have an interest in handicrafts.
燕平：你似是颇为喜爱手工制品。

Leonid: Hm? Oh! A sudden change of topic. Y-yes, of course. I wasn't lying to you ...
列昂尼德：嗯……？哦！您的话题可太难追上了，幸好我步子快。当然，我先前说的这些都是真心话……

Yanping: I made note of the place you mentioned ...
燕平：你此前所提及之处，我已记下。

Leonid: You did? That's good. In fact, if you ever go there, do you mind bringing me a couple of things ...
列昂尼德：您记得！那好，您若是打算飞去瞧瞧，回程时是否能帮我捎带些小东西……

Yanping: ... And I'm hoping you might remember this place of mine.
燕平：我想，也许你看过这些，也能将其记住。

Yanping: We are born with the talents of speaking human language and reading bones. Our bodies are a combination of humans and birds. They will turn into skeletons as soon as we die.
燕平：我们生来通人言，能勘骨相。身形似人，亦近似飞鸟。一但身死，顷刻便化作白骨。

Yanping: It is my people's belief that we should witness as many beings and events as we can. To record them in our bones while we are still alive.
燕平：族群相信，活着便意味着尽可能地记录所见，将它们全部藏纳于骨骸之中。

Yanping: And after our death, our bones will be taken to our next home.
燕平：而那些死去的族人，他们的骨头会被携往新的栖息地。

Yanping: We moved from the borderlands to the Central Plains because of war.
燕平：因战火蔓延，我们从边疆迁至中原。

Yanping: Our future changed dramatically not long after we'd arrived. Then, one by one, my people left the mountain; now more and more bones are brought back, and with the bones come rumors ... tales about us.
燕平：此处风光与过往不同，族人们不断下山，回到山中的只有越来越多的骸骨，以及各异的传言。

Yanping: People in the human world call us Mièméngs,
燕平：山下人称我们为灭蒙鸟。

Yanping: yet we prefer to call the entire race by one surname, which is Gětiān.
燕平：但我们更愿意取用一个姓氏，来指代整个族群：葛天。

Yanping: And I am the first Gětiān ever born in the Central Plains.
燕平：——而我是第一只诞生在中原的葛天。

A mountain breeze rises, gentler than the icy wind of the land where they had been, it rustles through both hair and feathers.
山风扑面，比冻土之上夹杂着雪粒的寒风要柔和，拂动鸟儿的羽毛与驻足者的发丝。

They hear the footsteps of animals on soft earth, the patter of tree branches, and the humming of water in a brook.
而林野中的声音似乎又是相近的，兽类的脚爪在土壤和枝条上轻轻放落，流水淌过石块的间隙，响动细微绵延。

Getian: For a very long time, I simply roosted on this tree.
葛天：在相当久的一段时间里，我只是栖在这棵槐树上。

Getian: As the days passed, fewer and fewer of my people visited me. Most had become the lazy bones lying in the temple.
葛天：不再有族人偶尔前来与我搭话，他们大多都彻底停下，成为了祠堂中的骨头。

Getian: The bones never lied about their owner's character. Some could be talkative, some were taciturn.
葛天：骨头总是诚实的。有些吵闹，有些始终不发一言。

Getian: The lives of mortals then scarcely intrigued me, but the life in the mountain had grown dull in equal measure.
葛天：下山实在无趣，在山中又无事可做。

Getian: Until a thought dawned on me: though humans cannot read bones, they have their own ways to pass on memories.
葛天：不知是哪一日，我忽而想到，山下人无法阅读骨相，但也有自己的方式，记取所历所感。

Getian: They write, or draw; they compose music, they shape mud and earth or carve solid stone ...
葛天：书画，诗文，乐律，雕刻，乃至许多其他事物……

Getian: I have mastered all these skills and read the lives of my people, almost every one of them. I will make an attempt.
葛天：——我掌握了一切与此相关的技艺，也读过了几乎每位族人的生平。我可以做出尝试。

Leonid: What are you going to show me? A room full of treasures?
列昂尼德：您打算带我去看什么？一间藏满珍宝的展室么？

Getian: A room with only lifeless objects.
葛天：一间仅有死物的房间。

Getian: Please come in.
葛天：请进。

Getian: My wand is made of bone, the bone from one of my people. He had taken a lot of trouble on my behalf before I left the mountain.
葛天： 我的骨杖，用材取自一位族人。下山之前，他曾对我多加照拂。

Getian: His bones were never returned to this temple; for a long time, I assumed he was alive somewhere far beyond the mountain. Until one day I overheard the bones speaking, and they mentioned where his remains lied.
葛天： 我不曾在祠堂中见到他的骨头，本以为他仍旧活着。直到无意中借其他骨骸所说的话语，找到了他所在的地方。

Getian: The temple he last stayed at was not far away from the city. The place was long deserted ... He gave up his life, neither wanting to return to his people nor to be remembered and worshiped into posterity.
葛天： 原来那座庙宇就在不远的城郊，早已破败不堪……他不为后世香火，亦不为回归族群。

Getian: I didn't understand his choice.
葛天： 我不明白。不过，这也是他的选择。

Getian: I choose not to take him back to our temple, as he wished it to be. But I took his story home, to write it down in one of these scrolls.
葛天： 所以，我并未将他带回祠堂。但这些卷轴之中，仍有着关于他的故事。

Leonid: This isn't a very large room, but it would be some effort to find anything specific.
列昂尼德： 这间屋子不算大，但要从中寻出特定的记录，应该是件麻烦事。

Aided only by the dim light seeping in from the outside, Leonid squints at the collections waiting in the dark.
年轻人费力地借助昏暗的光线辨别那些收藏的轮廓。

Some things are hung in the air, while others appear casually tossed aside. Barely visible in the dark clutter; bones and carvings, losing their dull luster to age.
悬挂的纸张，铺散的纸张，掩藏在纸张之下的雕刻与缺少光泽的骨骼。

Leonid: How are you going to find the right scroll in a dark room like this?
列昂尼德： ……您要如何找出所说的那卷故事呢?

Getian: Not a concern.
葛天： 不必找。

The bird turns his head and the room is suddenly basked in warm lamp light.
鸟儿偏过头，室内骤然亮起的灯火带来一片黄昏颜色。

Getian: "Who can tell the difference between the bones of the great and those of the ordinary? One should seek the pleasure of life, not the future after death."
葛天： “腐骨一矣，孰知其异？且趣当生，奚遑死后?”

Although the language he speaks is completely unfamiliar to him, the young man seems to understand the meaning of each word.
这段话语虽然措辞陌生，年轻人却能领会其中的意思。

It dawns on him that Gětiān is continuing to use his powers to keep their conversation smooth and clear.
看来葛天有意维持着用于沟通的神秘术。

Leonid: That's true. Whatever we have done when we are alive, we will become a pile of bones after we die.
列昂尼德： 的确，无论生前是何种模样，死后也都只是一堆骨头。

He looks around and gasps out of amazement.
他环顾四周，并由衷地抽了口气。

Leonid: Your collections ... and these works. I'm amazed.
列昂尼德： 您的收藏……以及作品，真是令人惊叹。

Leonid: You truly are one of the best craftsme- er, birds, I've ever seen.
列昂尼德： 即使与那些声名颇盛的工匠相比，您也会是其中格外出色的一位。

Getian: Is that so?
葛天： 这样么。

Getian: Thank you.
葛天： 多谢。

The temple is quiet. Words are unnecessary here, for they are useless to the dead.
这不是需要过多言语的时机。向已消逝的昨日之物吐露任何词句，最终都只是掷向空洞。于是唯有静默。

The only sounds in the room are Gětiān's feathers brushing across the scrolls.
在这份寂静之中，年轻人听见羽毛拂过卷轴纸面的声响。

6#1
6#1

平芜尽处
After the Endless Plain CH16603-08

The tea is still warm; as if the people there had never left the room.
桌面上的茶杯仍然触手温热，仿佛原先坐在此处的人只是离开了片刻。

Leonid: Phew. Home safe. No one's brain is permanently wrecked. Thank goodness.
列昂尼德： 呼，我们好端端地回到了这儿，没出什么岔子，也没把自己弄得发疯，真是万幸。

Leonid: But I'd never regret taking this journey with you, sir.
列昂尼德： 但这趟真算是值得，您所说的故事令我倍感震撼。

Leonid: Earlier, you said your name was Yànpíng ... But you call yourself Gětiān, after your people, so what do I call you?
列昂尼德： 您……我该如何称呼您?

Getian: If you don't mind, simply call me "Gětiān."
葛天： 若无其他必须，还请以“葛天”指代我。

He pauses for a moment, and solemnly speaks the young man's name.
他答完话，想了一想，清晰且郑重地念出年轻人的名字。

Getian: Leonid.
葛天： 列昂尼德。

Leonid: Yes? I'm listening.
列昂尼德： 您请讲，我正听着呢。

Getian: Is that your true name?
葛天： 这一称呼，又是否为你的真实名姓?

Leonid: Oh. Like I said in the beginning, names aren't important. We use them only for the sake of communication ... Hope mine is not too tough to remember.
列昂尼德： 喔，做自我介绍时我曾同您说过，名字不太重要，只是为了聊天儿方便……至少它还算好记，不是吗?

Leonid: If you wish to know the name I usually go with ... My other colleagues always refer to me as "Name Day."
列昂尼德：但如果您想知道的是那个“更常用”的词，其他职员通常会称呼我的代号，“命名日”。

A second introduction. Like a handshake from a friend.
另一次互通名姓。来得稍有些迟，近似于同路人友好的点头致意。

Getian: I see.
葛天：如此。

Name Day: A toast to you, Mr. Gětiān.
命名日：那么，来干一杯吧。葛天先生。

The young man raises his cup.
年轻人摩挲着杯壁，将茶杯高高举起。

Name Day: To peace.
命名日：为平安。

Getian: ... To peace.
葛天：……为平安。

The bird extends his wing and pushes his cup towards the man. The man lowers his.
鸟儿伸出翅膀，将面前的茶杯稍稍推向前方，而年轻人放低了手臂。

The cups reach each other, making a single clink.
两只杯子碰撞出一声清亮的脆响。

Name Day: It's still nagging at me. When did you figure out that we were dreaming?
命名日：我还是没能想明白，您是何时发现我们仍在人工梦游中的?

Getian: The very moment you appeared as "Lǐzhèng."
葛天：早在你扮作里正之时。

Name Day: How ... Did I do something wrong?
命名日：这……难道是我出了什么格外显眼的岔子?

Getian: No. It was only that you asked me about my friends' whereabouts.
葛天：实际上，是因你问及了我友人的去向。

Getian: It was odd that you'd ask.
葛天：其中有些许无法合辙之处，这才使我猜测并明了身处幻境。

Getian: And that besides, your bones were a poor match to his appearance.
葛天：另外，扮作里正时，你的骨相实在与外表不相衬。

Getian: Illusions are difficult to perform, much like this Artificial Somnambulism. With diligent practice, you might become very good indeed.
葛天：幻术的确难把握，想必这人工梦游也是同样。你勤加练习便可。

Name Day: Now you do sound like someone who's centuries old.
命名日：您要这样说，可就太有长辈的架子了……

Name Day: Let me get all the information sorted out, hopefully I will have some time left to show you around in the branch. The one in reality, of course.
命名日：我们还是快些将问题全理清楚，我好带您到真正的、实在的分部逛一逛……

Getian: Take your time.
葛天：不妨事，皆为外物。

But the man busily digging into his files seems not to hear him.
对面埋头翻阅文件记录的人并未听见这句话。

Name Day: I'll put you down as ... "not hostile." In fact, you are kind, sensible, and very pleasant to converse with.
命名日：我认为，您的确没有敌意，是友善、理智，能够进行正常沟通的对象。

Name Day: But I will have to ask that question again.
命名日：但在最后，我还是要例行问出那个您不曾解答的问题。

Name Day: Please don't worry. My job is done, so your answer won't affect your assessment.
命名日：因为对您的观察已经结束，我也做出了结论，您接下来的回答并不会影响结果。

Getian: I see. Finish what you have started.
葛天：嗯。凡事应有始终。

Name Day: When we first met, I asked you which was more important to you, the bone wand or the jade pendant.
命名日：这是我在最初见面时所提的，我曾询问您，您的骨杖与玉佩哪个更为重要。

Name Day: At that time, I was only trying to figure out if you had a preference. One perhaps you shared with humans and arcanists.
命名日：当时我们试图以此为切入点，了解您是否有某种偏向性——更亲近人类，或是更亲近神秘学家。

Name Day: But you already answered that through your stories: you treat them both as equals. Just as you value the wand and pendant.
命名日：但您用故事告诉我，这两者对您来说是等同的。

Name Day: Are you sure you value them equally? What if you have to give up either of them to survive one day?
命名日：它们的确没有高低吗？如果您真正面对需要失去它们之一，才能脱困的情况，又要怎么办呢？

Getian: As we talked, I worried whether you might take the wand and the pendant from me.
葛天：在交谈中，我也曾猜测你们是否会取走这两样物件。

He looks into the young man's eyes.
鸟儿注视着年轻人的眼睛。

Getian: I told myself you meant no harm. You only wanted to learn more about me.
葛天：我想，你们所求不过是了解更多。

Getian: From my story, you should know there is always a third option for me ...
葛天：但当我讲述完这些故事，也许你们会注意到另一样东西。

Getian: I would have traded my life for them.
葛天：我做好了用它交换它们的准备。

Getian: If I had to make a choice between the wand and the pendant, I would give you my bones.
葛天：——若要在骨杖与玉佩之间选择，我会交出我的骨头。

Name Day: Your bones.
命名日：您的骨头。

Slowly, he repeats the words and nods.
他缓慢地重复这句话，点了点头。

Name Day: I didn't expect that answer.
命名日：这个答案，是我从来没有预想过的。

He closes his notebook, and rises to push the chair back under the table, before turning around.
合上笔记本，将椅子推回原位，年轻人转过身去。

Name Day: Please wait another moment. I need to pause the Artificial Somnambulism program first and bring you back to the waking world as the protocol requested.
命名日：还得请您稍等一会儿，我需要先行结束人工梦游，然后依据操作流程将您唤醒。

Name Day: I wish you a wonderful journey from here on. Your registration documents will be issued shortly.
命名日：……祝您接下来的旅程顺利，我会尽快为您开具登记证明。

Name Day: Not long before, we encountered a poet from an island. Perhaps you will see him too in the future; I think you'd have a great time together.
命名日：此前基金会曾接触了一位岛上的诗人。要是您有机会碰上他，或许也能同他聊一聊您所作的文章。

Getian: I will look forward to it.
葛天：若是如此，想来确是有趣。

Name Day: Also ... I didn't lie about my love of stories. Should you hear more during your journey, I hope you might share them with me.
命名日：还有，如果您在途中得到了新鲜故事……我会始终期待着您的来信。

Name Day: Can you write with your wings? Like using a quill pen.
命名日：您会用翅膀写信吗，就像羽毛笔那样?

Getian: I will attempt to do so.
葛天：这也可以一试。

The bird raises his wing; performing something as close to a wave as he can do.
鸟儿朝年轻人扬了扬翅膀，像一个简单的道别。

Getian: Goodbye.
葛天：再会。

Finally returning to his solitude. The bird preens himself while enjoying the peace of the moment.
短暂的独处时光终于到来，鸟儿梳理着翅膀内侧的绒羽，享受着久违的平静。

He has seen and heard so much since he left the mountain, but rarely took the time to look back on his stories.
自离开族地后，他所经历的一切远胜过往，却还不曾有机会加以思索整理。

The tea, the ink, the paper. The metal pot, the wooden table, the stone paved road. So many things he had never seen in the mountains.
茶叶，墨水，纸张。金属水壶，木质长桌，砖石铺就的地面。所有的人工造物。

He was a newborn chick, and the mountain, the brook, and the forest were his shell. Now the shell has been gently cracked, and he flows out into a bowl.
山峦、溪水与林木曾是将他环绕的卵壳，如今它们已被轻轻敲破，于是他骤然被倾入一只碗中。

That bowl might be roughly made, but the liquid inside is clear and good, reflecting the sky, the mountains, and everything ...
碗壁粗糙，但其中液体清亮，映出天地悠悠。

Getian: Perhaps this explains why people in the human world love liquor.
葛天：山下人对杯中之物的喜好，或是由此而来。

Getian: I should have drunk with them, when I had the chance.
葛天：当时，也应与他们……同饮一回的。

The bird closes his eyes.
鸟儿闭上眼睛。

There is still time to enjoy the moment, before he wakes up from this dream.
在人工梦游结束之前，尚有片刻可用于怀念。

Getian: Life beyond the mountain is indeed chaotic.
葛天：山下的确喧闹，几乎片刻不得清净，灯火也易扰了眼睛。

Getian: I never intended to stay long in the city after that transformation mystery was solved.
葛天：我本打算解决城中一事后，便不再逗留。

Getian: But now, I'm even further away from home.
葛天：如今，却是身在此处，离族地越发遥远。

Getian: Perhaps I will never return home again.
葛天：想来，或许再难回返。

Getian: Even so it was good to see it once more ... if only in a dream.
葛天：也恰好借着这幻境，再见上一见。

Gětiān sits on the scholar tree, just as he had before. With the wind still blowing through his feathers.
鸟儿仍然栖在槐树的枝干之上，风也依旧拂动着他的羽毛。

But he feels now that he is no longer as he was.
只是未曾动身，与选择回返，两者的心境恐怕不再相同。

Getian: If time went back to that day, I would still fly down the mountain.
葛天：……但若是再作抉择，应当仍择下山一途。

Getian: The owner of that tavern was young. Stubborn, because of her youth. But she has always been true to herself.
葛天：那位酒坊娘子，年纪尚轻，且颇有些执拗。但所行皆是出自本心。

Getian: She grew up in that city, growing close to her neighbors, she loved them like they were her own kin.
葛天：她与城中众人，恰如同族，彼此友爱。也是因着在此城生长，才使她始终有此为旁人思索的心思罢。

Getian: If she did jump over that bridge, she must be a real Xiángruì now. She must be pleased.
葛天：既过得那桥，也应了传说所言的“祥瑞”一词。她应当会高兴。

Getian: As for those two foreign merchants, they weren't scared away by all the trouble. They stayed till the very end.
葛天：那两名胡商，也曾与我坦诚相谈，面对城中混乱不曾走避，竟也留至最后。

Getian: That day, I saw the lanterns floating down the river glowing brighter than ever before.
葛天：况且，我也得以再见河灯顺流而下的亮光，比过往都更为明亮。

Getian: And that Hexagram of Water and Fire. The choice to be made. Xū, with water above and sky below. The Hexagram of waiting.
葛天：水火既济，已有抉择。水天需，逢时机。

Getian: I hope they left the city with what they wanted. Till this day, I still wonder which path that lady with unreadable bones ultimately chose.
葛天：她二人终究也有所获。只不知，那位骨相不可勘读的年长者，究竟择了哪一条路。

Getian: That young man was another interesting person. I wonder whom I will meet next.
葛天：今日所识的年轻人，也是有趣。不知稍后出了幻境，又能见到怎样的光景。

Getian: How would I know the limits of the mountain if I didn't leave it? Yet the world turns out to be another bowl.
葛天：若非身至山下，怎能彻底明了曾在山中。天地过客，皆要入此杯盏。

Getian: Fine. I shall listen to the wind before anything comes up.
葛天： 也好。可趁无事，暂且听风。

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